

Order Up! QSR Spotlight Report 2026

Unlock the latest trends and insights into
QSR mobile apps and digital advertising



Executive Summary | Key Takeaways

01

Demand for QSR Apps Continues to Rise Globally

QSR apps sustained positive growth for both downloads and sessions globally in 2025. In mature markets like the US, adding new users is becoming more difficult even as engagement continues to rise.



02

Mobile Remains a Key Part of QSR Strategy for Improving Customer Loyalty

Mobile has become almost required for QSR brands, with most of the top advertisers also having a strong presence on mobile. Apps present a great way to improve the user experience while also providing easily accessible rewards for loyal customers.



03

Social Channels Can Help Reach a Mobile-Friendly Audience Beyond Linear TV and OTT

Linear TV and OTT are still popular choices for most QSR advertisers, accounting for roughly half of digital ad spend in the US. Social channels can help brands reach a targeted mobile-friendly audience, like Crumbl's appeal to younger women on Snapchat.



04

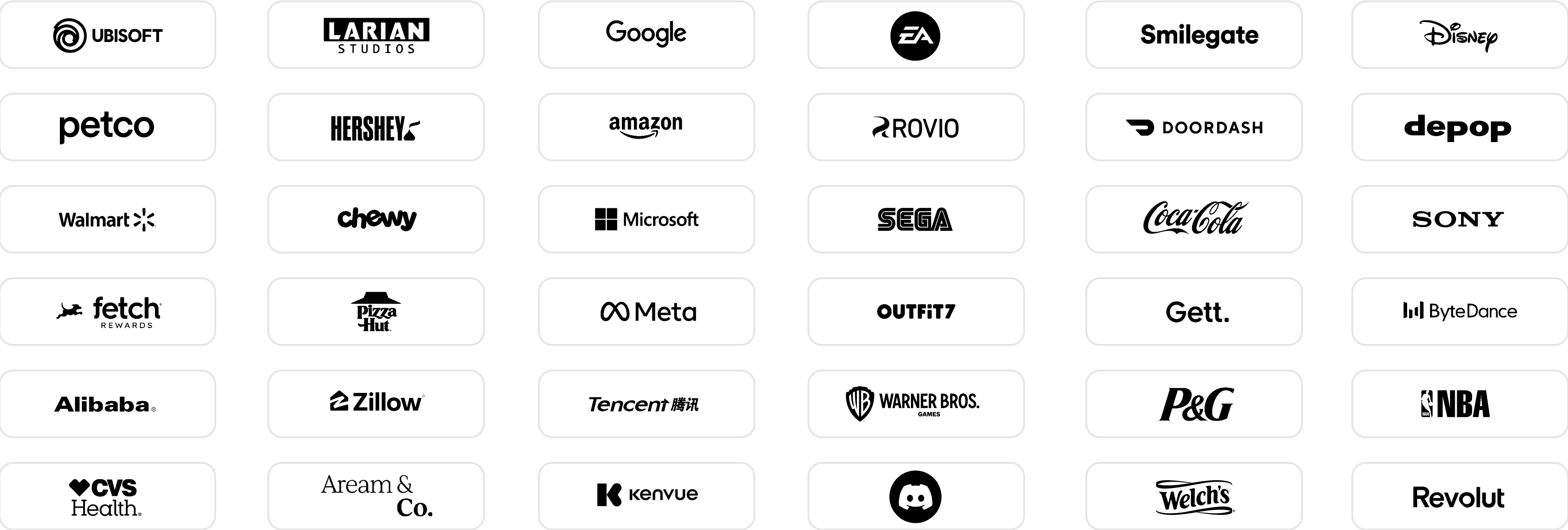
QSR and Food Delivery Partnerships Provide Opportunities to Boost Both Brands

Co-branded retail media advertising with food delivery services like Uber Eats, Grubhub, and DoorDash help give both brands a boost. Most recent creatives offer very generous incentives for first-time users as it has become harder to reach a new audience.



Sensor Tower | Our Customers

Top publishers trust Sensor Tower insights to grow their business



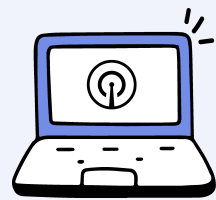
Note: Top publishers by app store revenue | Source: Sensor Tower

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About this Data:

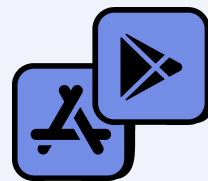
Mobile App Methodology



Sensor Tower's Market Insights team compiled the download and IAP revenue estimates provided in this report using the Sensor Tower Mobile App Insights platform.



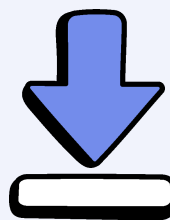
Android app download and revenue estimates represent downloads and revenue from the Google Play Store only. Sensor Tower does not provide download estimates for third-party Android stores.



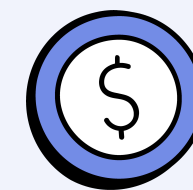
Figures cited in this report reflect iOS App Store and Google Play download and revenue estimates for January 1, 2014 through March 31, 2026.



In-app purchase (IAP) revenue includes paid downloads, in-app purchases, and subscriptions from the iOS App Store and Google Play. This does not include any revenue from advertisements or third-party purchases.



Download estimates presented are on a per-user basis, meaning that only one download per Apple or Google account is counted towards the total.



In-app purchase (IAP) revenue estimates are gross — inclusive of any percent taken by the app stores.

Mobile App Trends

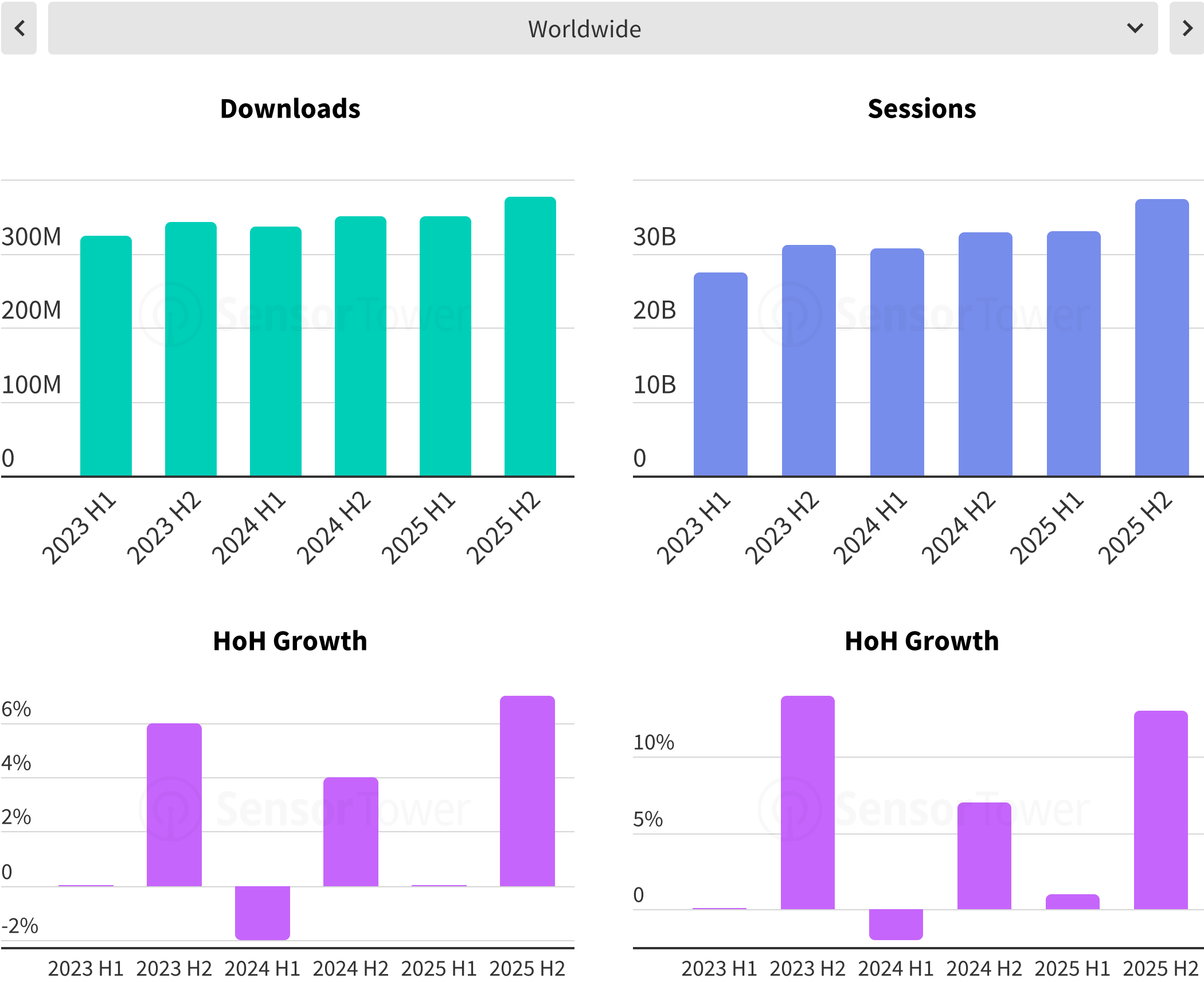
Sustained Growth in the Global QSR Market

The global QSR market remains on a sustained upward trajectory, with both downloads and user engagement hitting new milestones. Total downloads increased 7% YoY to 376 million in H2 2025. Meanwhile, total sessions surpassed 37 billion, demonstrating that the mobile-first QSR model is successfully scaling across international market.

In the US market, despite fluctuations in new downloads in 2025 with a slight 4% YoY decline, total sessions on QSR apps have consistently grown YoY. This indicates a highly mature QSR digital ecosystem where growth is increasingly powered by high-frequency user loyalty.

Source: Sensor Tower
Note: iOS and Google Play combined. iOS only for China. Apps classified using Sensor Tower's App IQ taxonomy as of April 2026.

Semiannual Trends for QSR Apps
iOS and Google Play



North American Downloads Stabilize as Asia Emerges as Global Growth Engine

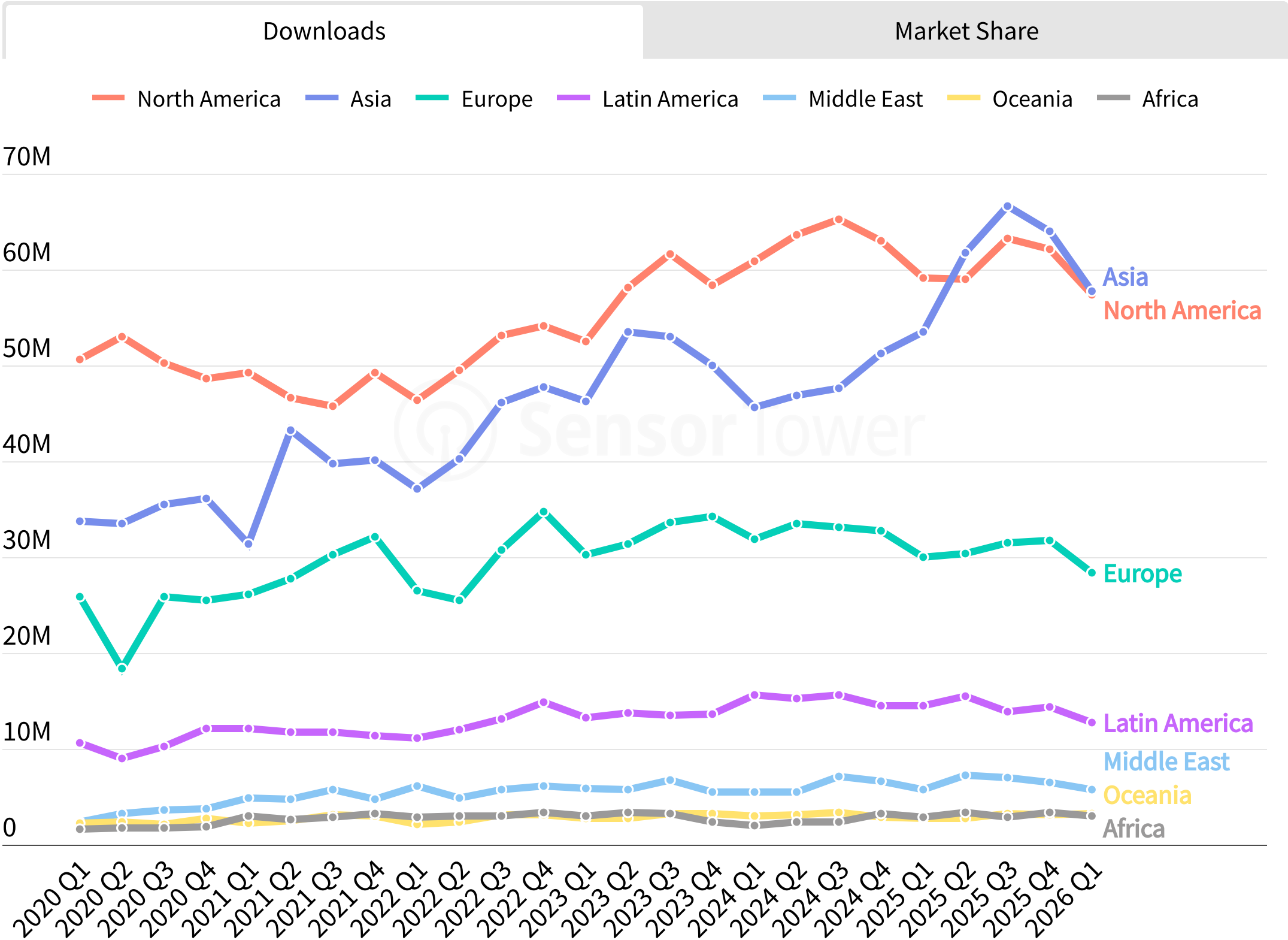
The North American digital landscape has transitioned from rapid user acquisition to market stabilization. Recent data shows a plateau in downloads, with Q1 2026 figures falling to 57M from 61M in Q1 2024. This signal of a saturated market underscores the increasing importance of prioritizing customer retention and session depth over new installs to maintain regional market share.

Asia is currently the global growth engine, led by an emerging Sandwich & Deli subgenre, which nearly doubled its downloads in Q1 2026 YoY. In contrast, the European and Latin American markets are experiencing a structural cooling, with downloads dropping 5% and 12% in Q1 2026 YoY, respectively.

Source: Sensor Tower
Note: iOS and Google Play combined. iOS only for China. Apps classified using Sensor Tower's App IQ taxonomy as of April 2026.

QSR App Download Trends by Region

iOS and Google Play



QSR App Downloads Soften in the US Market in 2025

The Burgers & Fries category maintained its dominant leadership in 2025, accounting for 31% of all QSR downloads in the US. While a slight 4% YoY contraction in downloads signals a maturing market, total sessions grew by a robust 12% YoY. This trend indicates a shift in focus from acquiring new users to deepening engagement with the existing install base.

Following a breakout 2024, which saw downloads surge by more than 20%, the Chicken and Mexican & Taco categories demonstrated significant resilience throughout 2025. Although new download volumes reached a stable plateau, engagement continued to climb. Taco Bell exemplified this shift toward deep loyalty, achieving a 40% increase in average MAUs.

Source: Sensor Tower
Note: iOS and Google Play combined. iOS only for China. Apps classified using Sensor Tower's App IQ taxonomy as of April 2026.

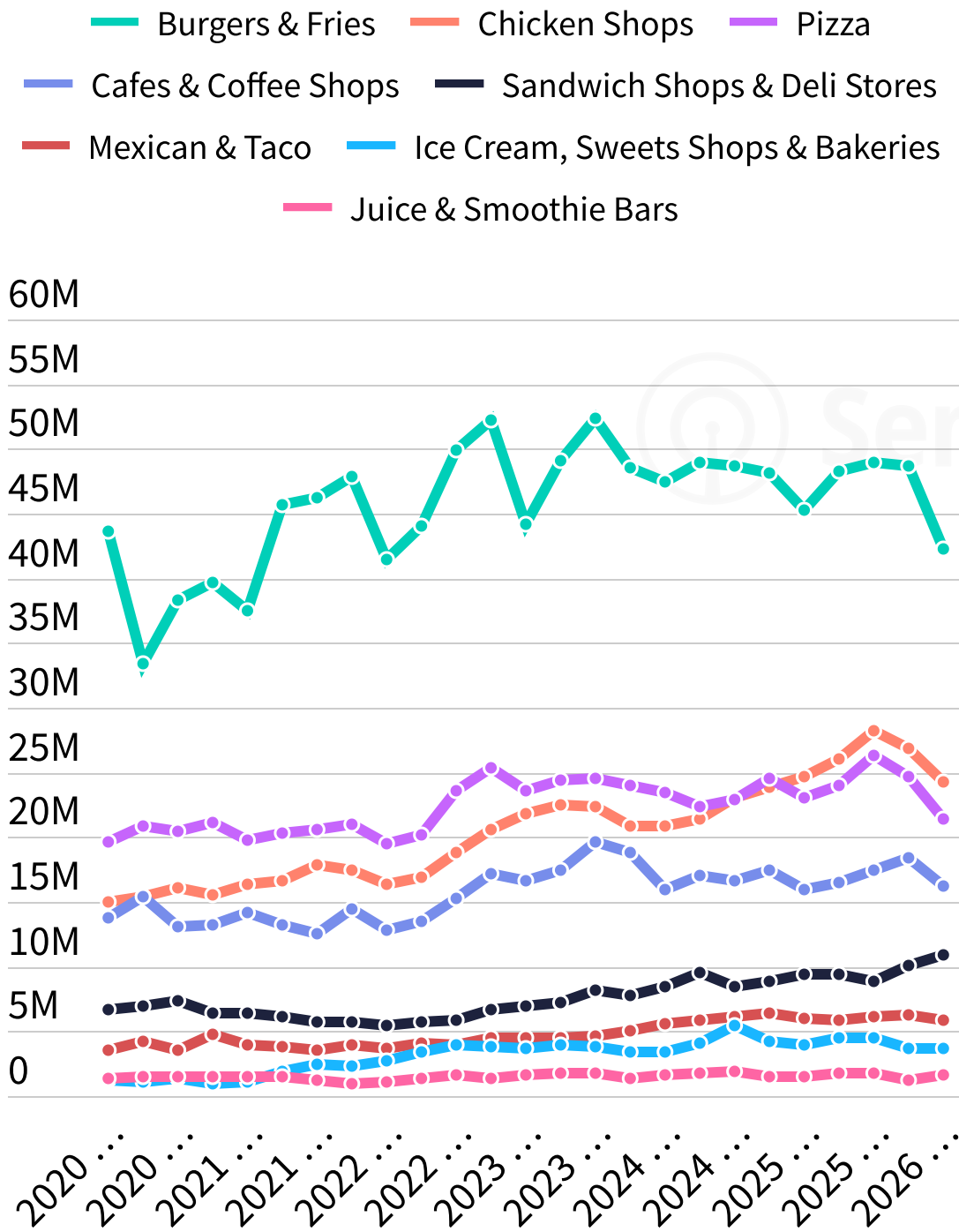
QSR Download Trends by Subgenre

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Worldwide

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Quarterly Downloads by Subgenre



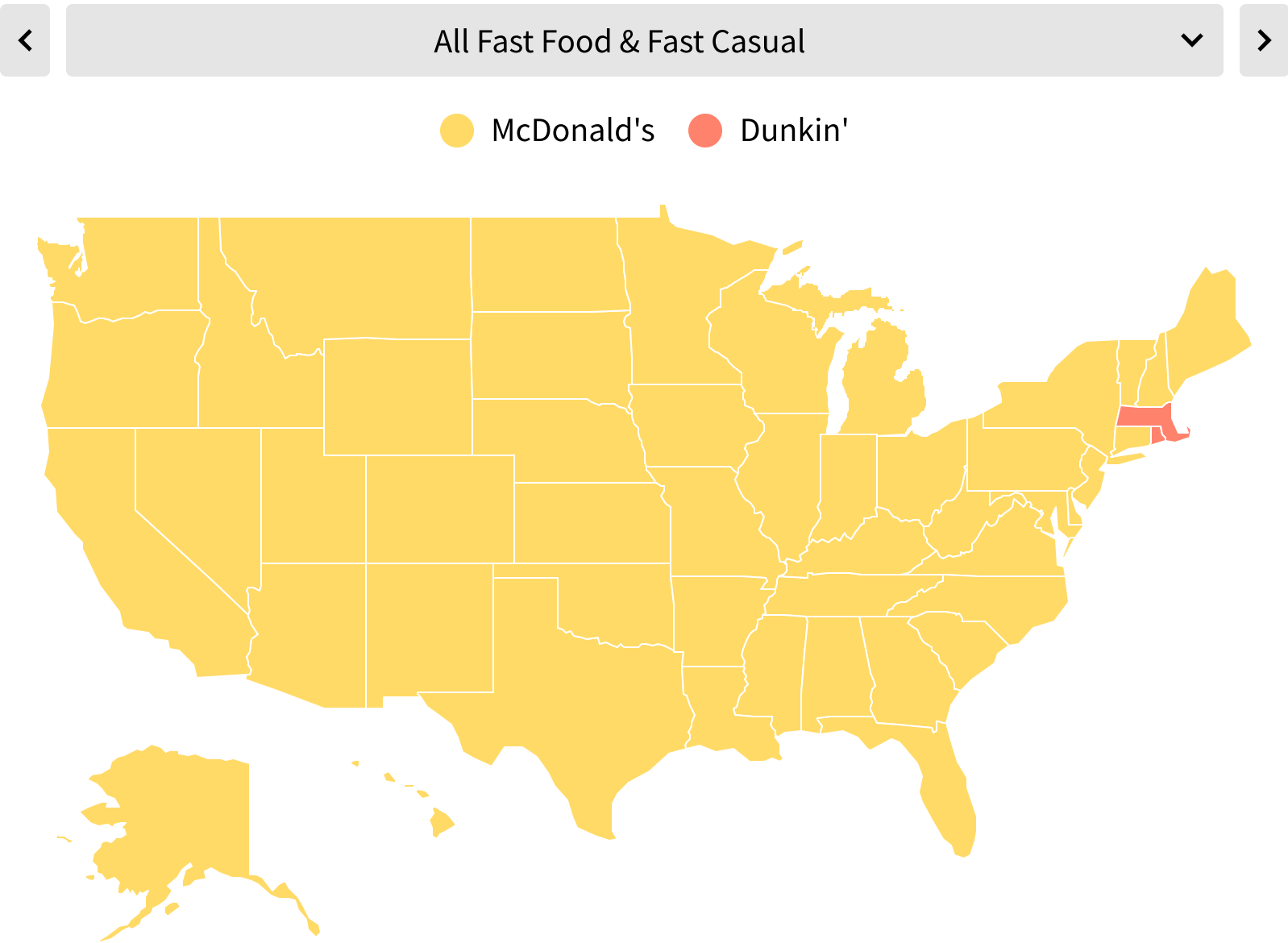
Top Apps by Downloads in Q1 2026

	App	Subgenre
1	McDonald's	Burgers & Fries
2	KFC	Chicken Shops
3	Domino's Pizza	Pizza
4	BURGER KING App	Burgers & Fries
5	Starbucks	Cafes & Coffee Shops
6	Pizza Hut	Pizza
7	Taco Bell	Mexican & Taco
8	Subway	Sandwich Shops & Deli Stores
9	Chick-fil-A	Chicken Shops
10	Popeyes	Chicken Shops

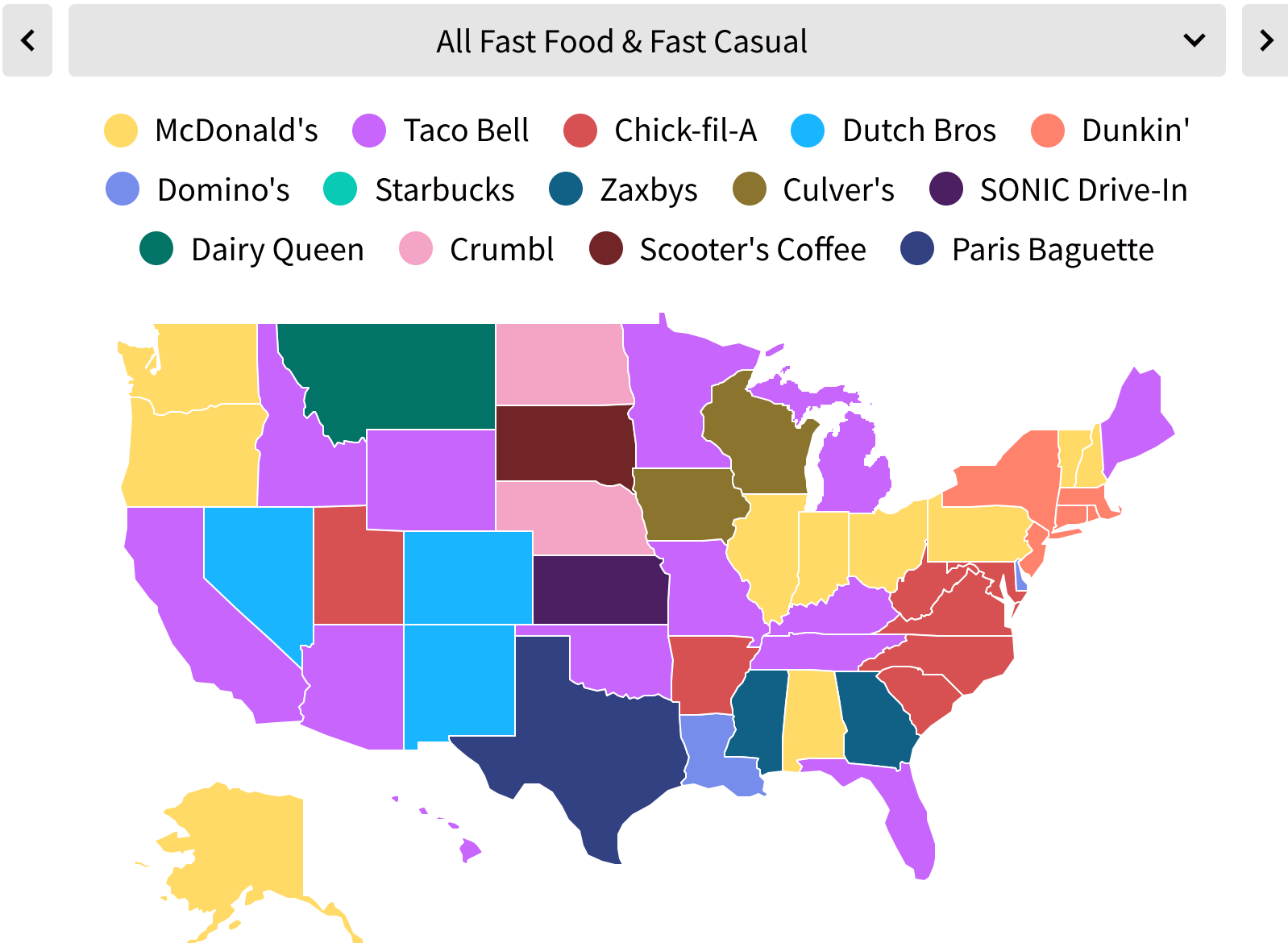
A Variety of QSR Apps are Breaking Out in Different US States

Most leading QSR apps maintain strong national footprints, like McDonald's (Burgers & Fries) and Chick-fil-A (Chicken Shops). However, new national and regional competitors are emerging. For example, Dutch Bros in the West and South and Dunkin' in the Midwest and Northeast are starting to gain ground on the leading Coffee Shop app, Starbucks.

Top QSR App by MAU in Each State, Q1 2026



Top QSR App by YoY MAU Growth in Each State, Q1 2026 vs. Q1 2025



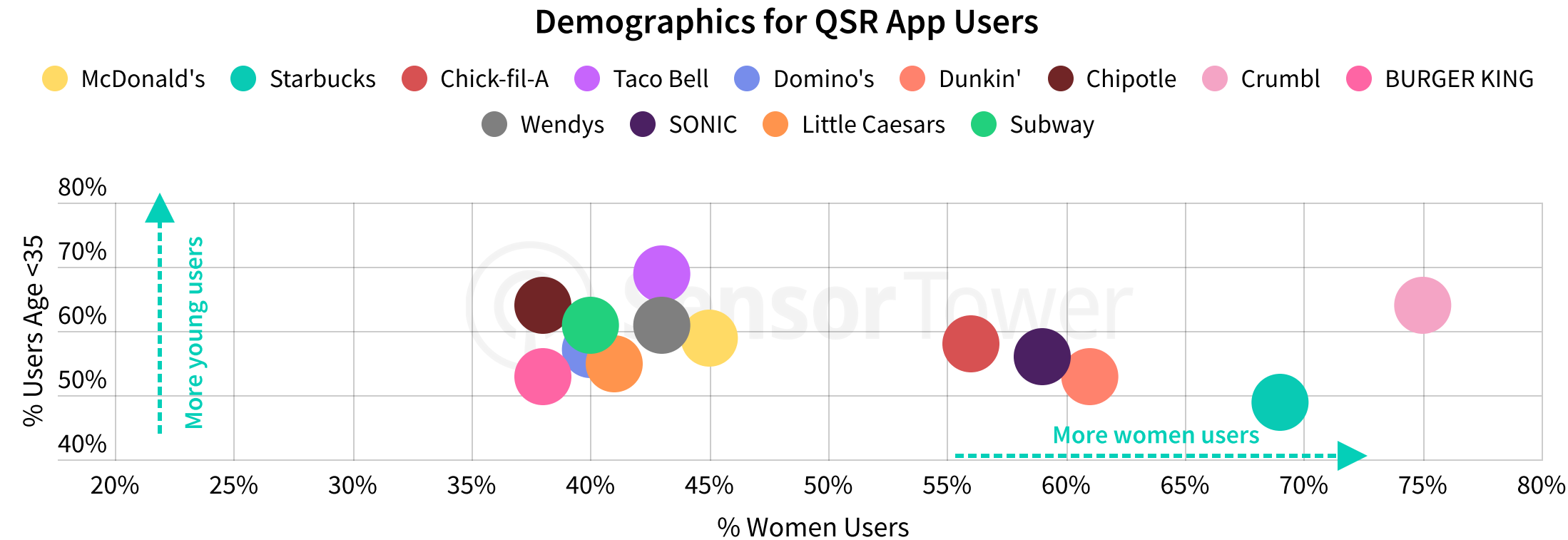
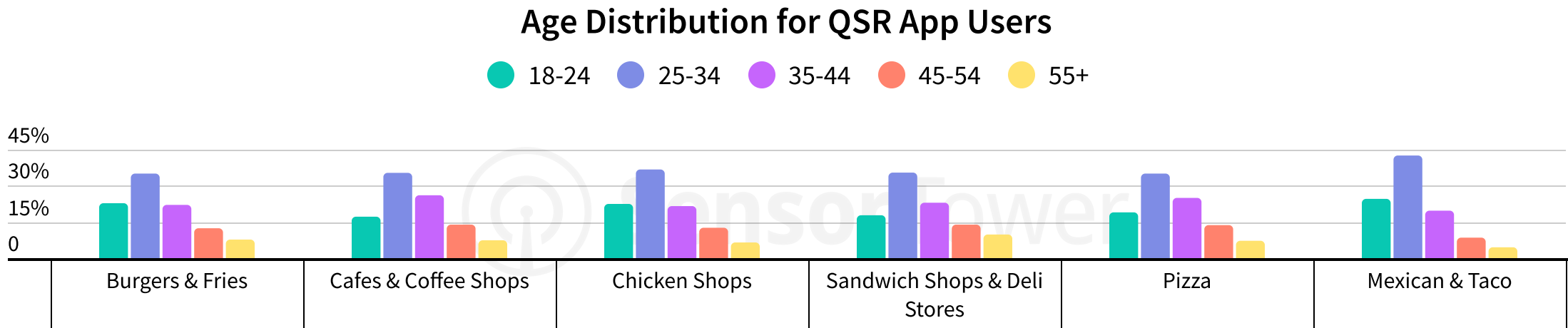
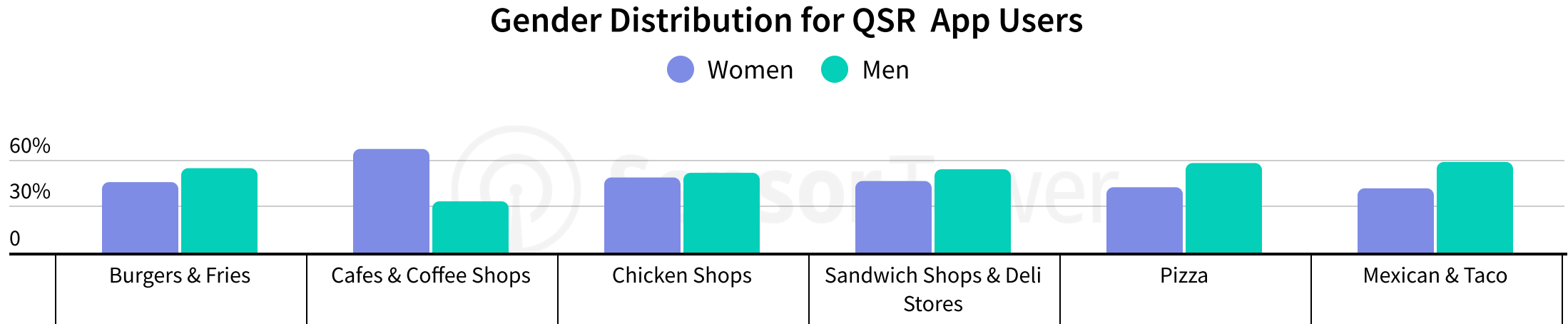
Source: Sensor Tower
Note: US geography breakdown for Q1 2026. N/A values for states where no top app saw positive year-over-year growth.

Cafes & Coffee Shops Apps' User Base Skews Heavily Female

Cafes & Coffee Shops attract a significantly female audience, led by Starbucks and Dunkin', where women comprise 69% and 61% of their respective user bases. Conversely, the Pizza (58% men) and Mexican & Taco (59% men) sub-genres skew heavily toward a male audience. The Burgers & Fries and Chicken Shops sectors maintain a more gender-balanced appeal, demonstrating their capacity to reach a broad audience.

The digital user profile for Taco Bell is notable for its resonance with a younger audience. More than two-thirds (69%) of its users are under the age of 35, the highest concentration of Gen Z and Millennials across the entire QSR industry.

Source: Sensor Tower
Note: Demographics for mobile app users on Android in the United States in Q1 2026. Gender represented as Men and Women only and is not representative of all gender identities.



QSR Has High Overlap with Moviegoers and Sports Fans

QSR apps exhibit an audience overlap with moviegoers and sports fans, linking fast food to entertainment and game-day routines. Notably, Pizza and Chicken Shop app users are the most likely to fit a 'Sports Fan' persona. By aligning promotions with major film releases and sports schedules, brands can effectively capture these high-intent leisure audiences.

Top Personas:
Increased Likelihood of User Falling into Persona (vs. the General Population) for Selected QSR Apps

Example: McDonald's app users are 1.1X more likely to fall into the Parents persona than the general population

persona	McDonald's	BURGER KING	Taco Bell	Domino's	Little Caesars	Pizza Hut	Popeyes	Wingstop	KFC	Subway	Starbucks	Dunkin'	Crumbl
Gig Workers	2.8	3.9	2.9	2.2	4.1	2.6	2.8	3.7	4.1	3.0	1.5	2.1	2.1
Moviegoers	2.5	3.0	2.8	3.1	3.2	3.3	5.6	5.7	4.2	3.5	2.4	2.8	2.5
Delivery Diners	2.5	3.3	2.6	2.4	3.1	3.4	3.1	3.3	3.9	2.5	1.7	2.0	1.7
Shopaholics	2.3	3.0	2.1	2.7	2.6	4.0	2.1	1.6	3.9	2.2	2.1	2.1	2.9
World Travelers	2.1	2.7	1.8	2.0	2.6	2.1	2.4	2.7	2.8	2.5	1.7	2.2	1.5
Home Cooks	1.9	2.7	2.2	2.6	2.1	2.6	2.4	1.6	3.5	2.1	2.5	2.5	2.6
Console Gamers	1.8	2.3	2.0	1.9	3.3	1.9	2.5	2.6	3.0	2.5	0.8	1.0	1.3
Sports Fans	1.7	2.1	1.7	2.5	1.7	2.7	2.0	2.8	2.9	2.0	1.3	1.8	1.4
Casual Gamers	1.6	2.9	1.8	1.9	1.7	2.0	1.5	1.5	2.2	2.3	1.7	2.0	1.4
Cord Cutters	1.6	1.9	1.5	1.4	1.6	1.8	1.8	2.1	2.1	1.5	1.8	1.6	1.9
PC Gamers	1.5	1.6	2.1	1.7	2.2	1.2	1.7	1.8	0.8	2.0	0.9	1.3	1.1
Crypto Traders	1.4	1.6	1.1	2.0	1.8	1.4	2.5	2.0	2.5	1.7	0.9	1.4	0.5
Frequent Flyers	1.3	1.4	1.2	1.6	1.1	1.2	1.2	1.5	1.5	1.5	2.5	1.8	1.0
Core Gamers	1.2	1.5	1.0	1.4	1.4	1.4	2.1	1.1	1.4	1.3	0.8	1.0	0.9
Students	1.2	1.4	1.3	1.2	1.4	0.5	1.2	1.0	0.7	1.1	1.4	1.1	1.9
Parents	1.1	1.6	0.7	0.9	1.3	1.2	0.3	0.6	0.8	0.9	0.9	0.8	1.3

Source: Sensor Tower
Note: Includes mobile app users on Android in the United States in Q1 2026.

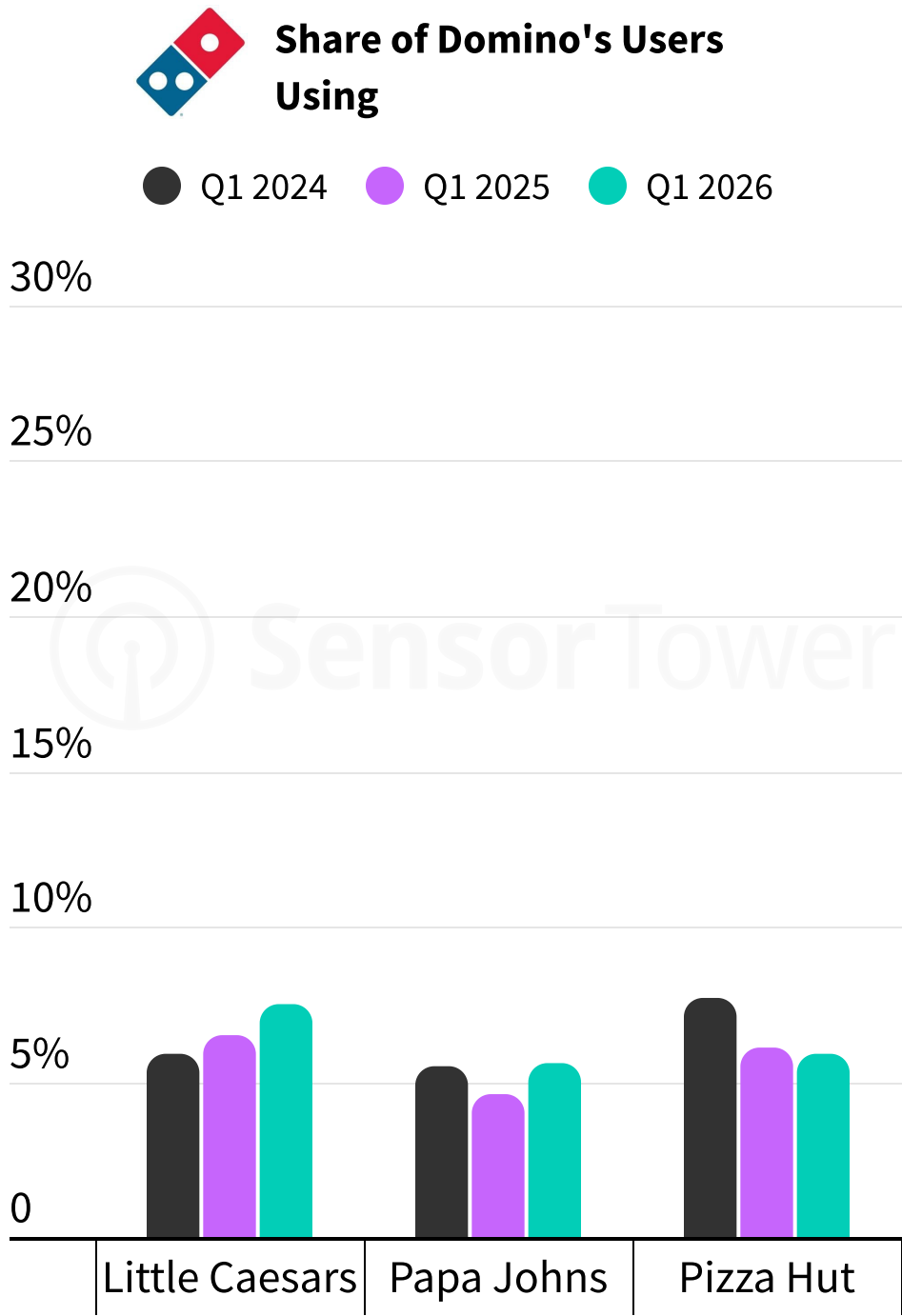
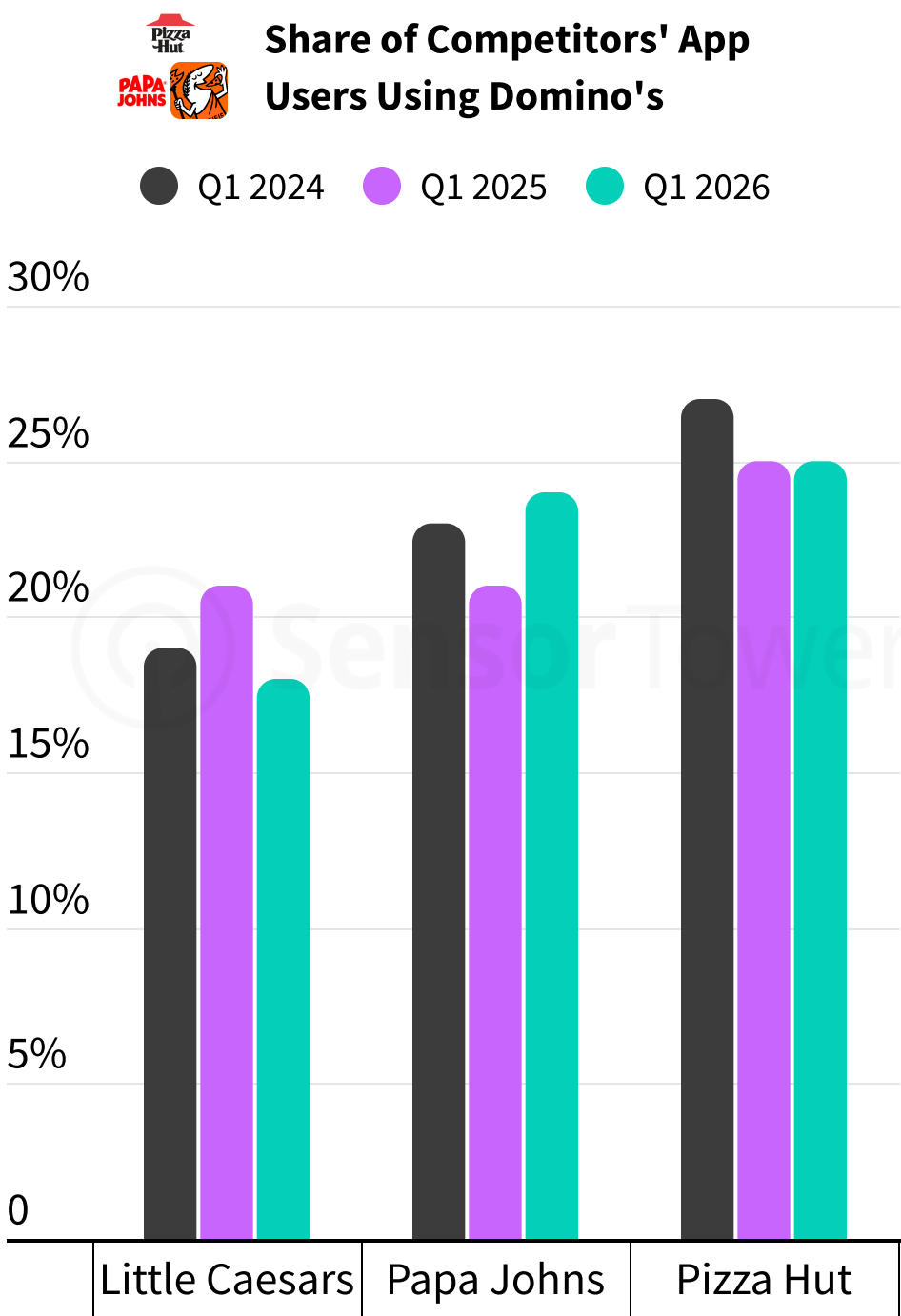
Domino's Leads Category in Exclusive App Loyalty

Domino's has cultivated remarkable digital loyalty, creating a one-way flow of traffic in the US pizza category. While a significant portion of users from other top pizza apps also engaged with the Domino's app in Q1 2026, with 25% of Pizza Hut users and 24% of Papa John's users accessing Domino's in the same month, fewer users of Domino's app explored these competing apps, with less than 7% using alternative pizza apps.

While Domino's maintains a massive lead in cross-app usage, Little Caesars is showing signs of increased audience resilience. In Q1 2026, the percentage of Little Caesars users cross-shopping on Domino's dropped by 3 percentage points YoY. This suggests that Little Caesars has successfully reinforced its own audience loyalty.

Source: Sensor Tower
Note: Overlap between Android users in the United States.

Percentage of App User Audience Using Competitors' Apps
Android Users in the United States



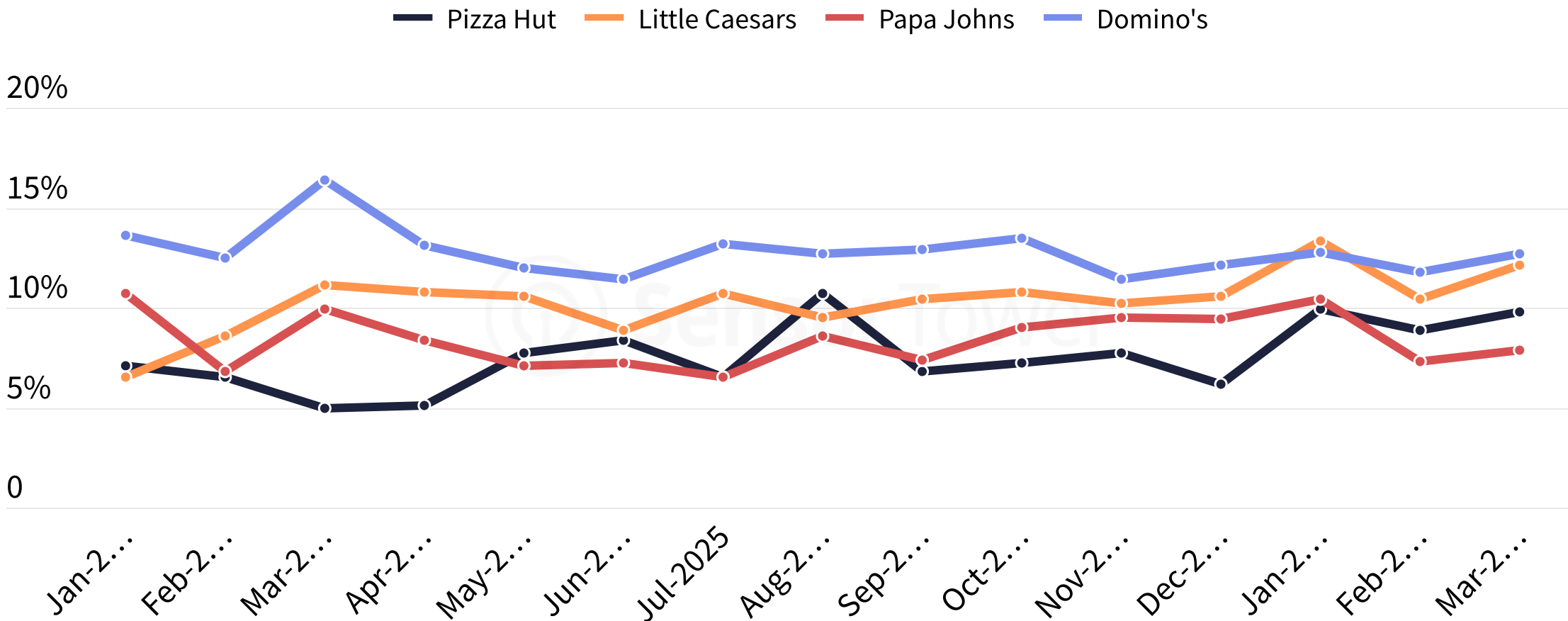
Little Caesars' Tiered Rewards Drive Digital Engagement to New Highs

While Domino's maintains the highest loyalty baseline, Little Caesars and Pizza Hut have emerged as the primary growth drivers, both increasing their power user share by over 3 percentage points YoY in Q1 2026. This surge has effectively closed the loyalty gap, with Little Caesars now trailing Domino's by 0.5 percentage point as of Q1 2026.

Unlike the 2024 NFL season, which relied on standard food rewards, Little Caesars' 2025 "Pizza! Pizza! Pregame" program utilized a tiered milestone system and interactive challenges to build long-term habits. By offering a guaranteed \$50 FanCash reward after five challenges and Super Bowl LX/Season Ticket sweepstakes for seasonal predictions, the brand incentivized recurring digital interaction. Its power user rate grew consistently QoQ throughout 2025, reaching a new peak of 12% in Q1 2026.

Source: Sensor Tower
Note: Android users in the United States.

Power Users Using >3 Days per Month %
Android Users in the United States



2024 NFL Campaign

littlecaesars Sponsored

CHALLENGES

GAMEDAY Grub JUST GOT MORE REWARDING!

ONLY DURING PIZZA! PIZZA! Pregame

Install Now

littlecaesars Huddle up for our Little Caesars® Challenges on gamedays & earn rewards while you chow down on your ... more

2025 NFL Campaign

Little Caesars Sponsored

Huddle up with Little Caesars® Challenges on gamedays & earn our Best Rewards while chowing down on your fave pizzas & more!

SCORE TICKETS TO SUPER BOWL LX

Predict your team's NFL season on our app for a chance to WIN Super Bowl LX tickets!

Pregame like a pro.

Order Now

littlecaesars Sponsored

SUPER BOWL LX SUPER BOWL LX

WIN \$100 IN FANCASH FROM FANATICS!

Open our app!

- Choose a team that will win this round of the playoffs
- If your pick wins, you're entered. If not, try again the next week!

Order Now

littlecaesars Be the biggest winner of the championship season to score BIG! Take your chance in the Road to the Super ... more

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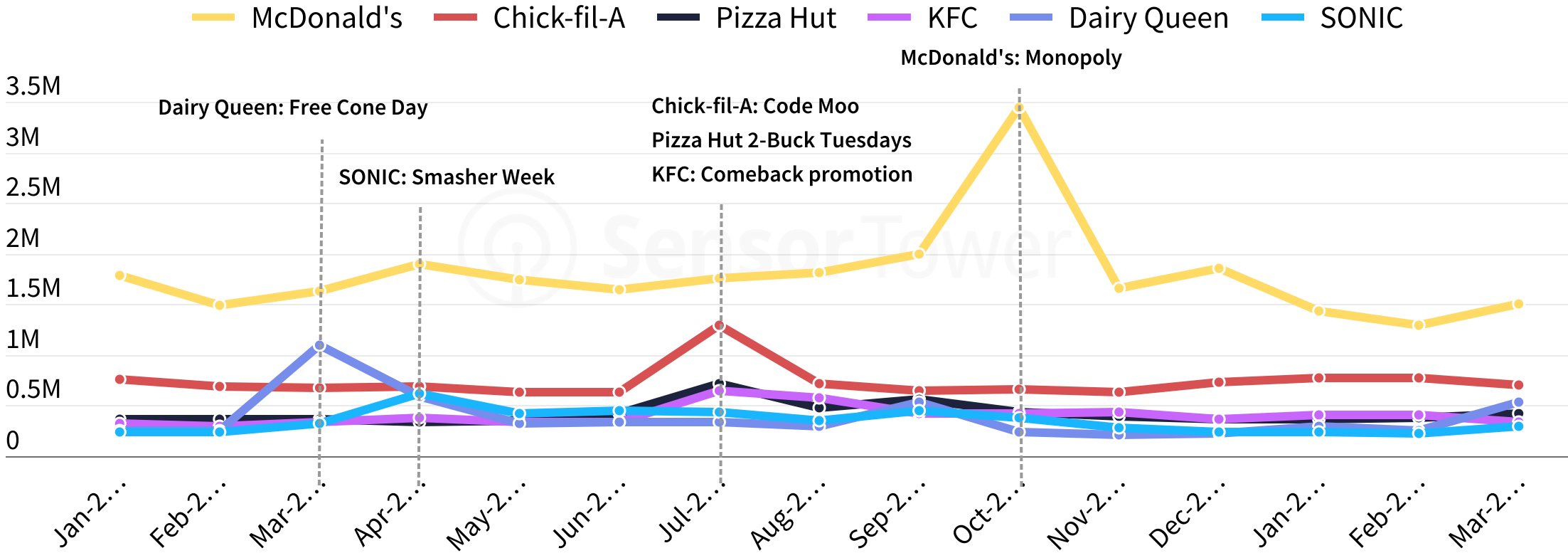
Interactive Events Create Higher Retention Baselines

While promotional events effectively drive massive download spikes for QSR brands, these surges often result in lower-than-average retention as "deal-seekers" quickly drop off. However, McDonald's and Chick-fil-A have successfully countered this trend. By using gamified, multi-week events like Monopoly and Code Moo, they move beyond simple discounts to build lasting digital habits.

New users acquired during McDonald's October Monopoly event outperformed the 2025 yearly average, with Week 1 retention staying nearly 1 percentage point (ppt) higher than the baseline and maintaining that lead through Week 10. Similarly, Chick-fil-A's Code Moo campaign in July showed great resilience. New users saw a Week 1 retention lift of 0.6ppt and remained above the annual average for the entire first month.

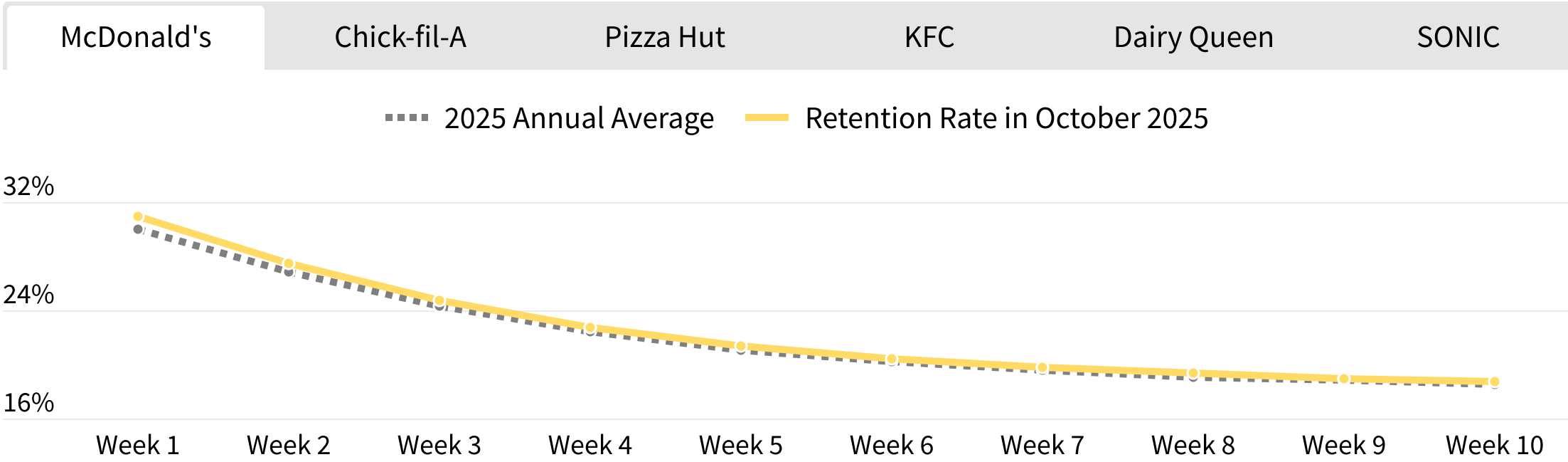
Source: Sensor Tower
Note: iOS and Google Play in the United States.

Monthly Downloads by QSR Apps in the United States



United States Weekly Retention Rate

2025 Annual Average vs. Promotional Period Performance



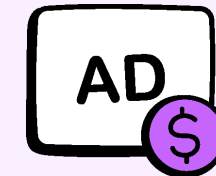
Digital Advertising

About this Data:

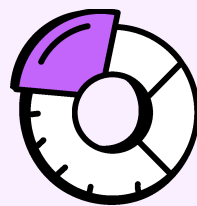
Digital Advertising Methodology



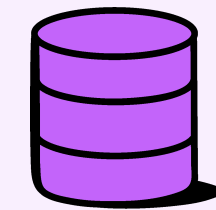
The digital ad spending and impressions estimates presented in this report were compiled by Sensor Tower's Market Insights team using Pathmatics by Sensor Tower Digital Advertising Insights.



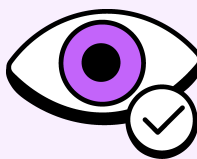
The figures mentioned in this report reflect estimated ad investments made by advertisers through September 30, 2025.



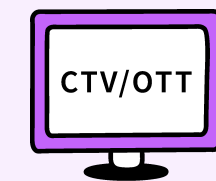
Data includes select channels in each market. Figures in this report represent the totals for these channels only, not across all digital formats.



Data Collection: Pathmatics collects a sample of digital ads from the web. In order to report the most complete picture of the digital advertising landscape, we utilize two leading data sourcing technologies: panels and data aggregators.



Pathmatics uses statistical sampling methods to estimate impressions, cost per thousand impressions (CPMs), and spend for each creative. Each impression served to our data aggregators and panelists is assigned a CPM, which when combined with impressions results in our spend estimates.



Pathmatics OTT data is powered by a panel of real OTT & CTV viewers and includes data representative of all Smart TV brands, such as Amazon Prime Video, Disney+, HBO Max, Hulu, Netflix, Pluto TV, Tubi, Peacock, and Paramount+.

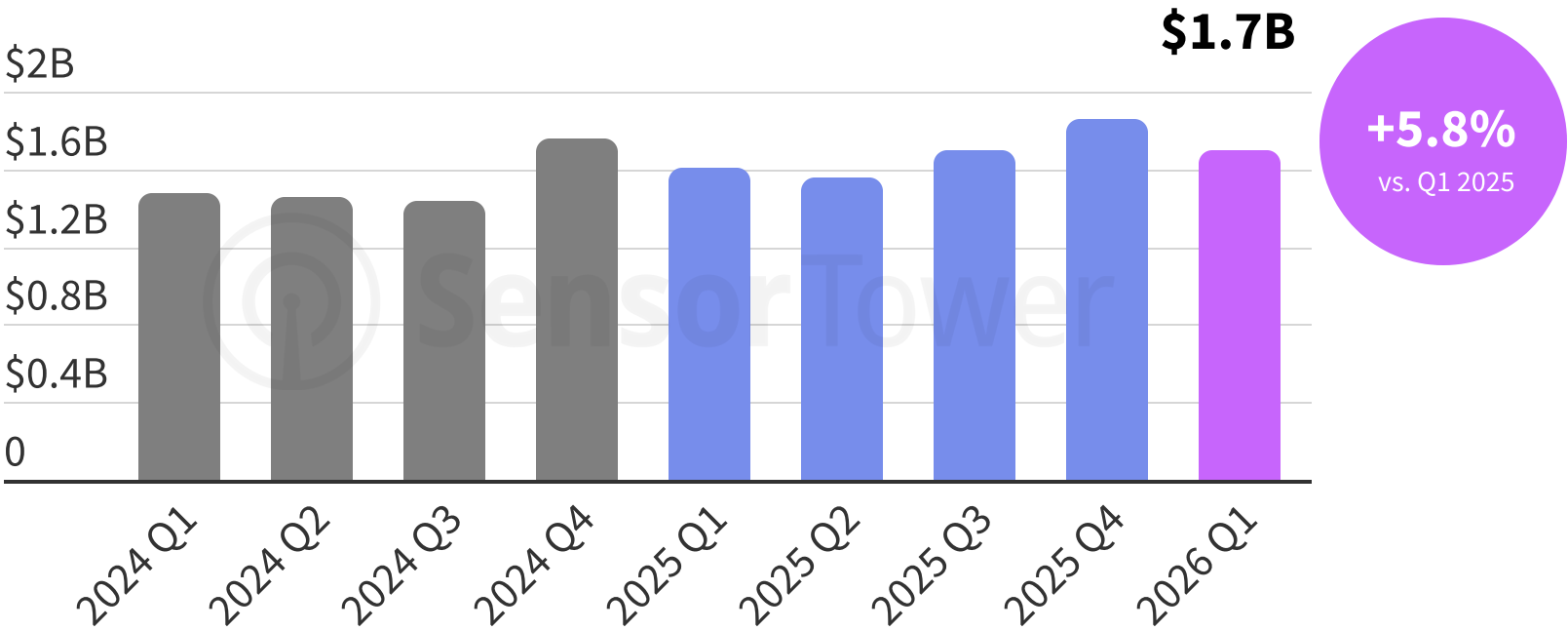
US QSR Ad Spend Climbs Steadily into 2026

Global digital ad spend by fast food and fast casual restaurant brands rose 5.8% year-over-year in Q1 2026, reaching \$1.7 billion. This figure reflects digital advertising across more than 30 markets and 18 channels, though channel coverage varies by market.

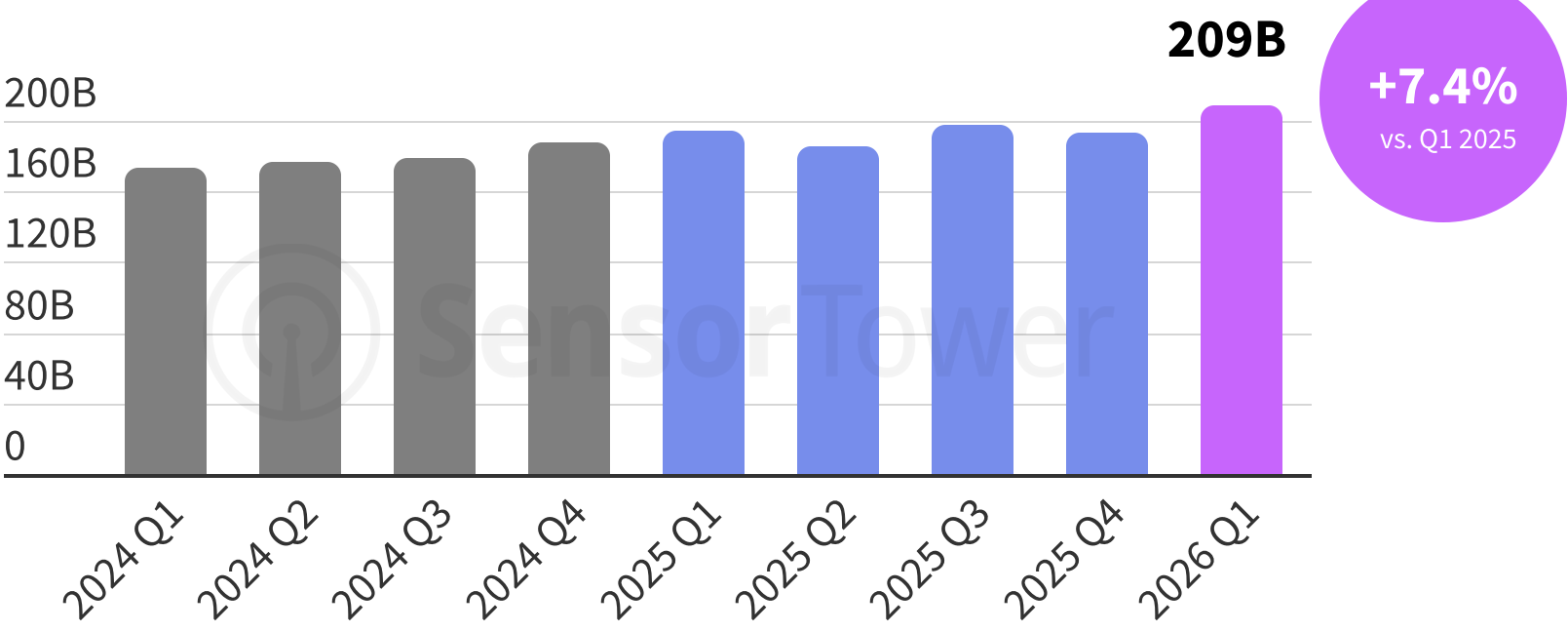
Performance differed significantly by region. In the US, digital ad spend increased a modest 3.7% YoY—well below the 30%+ growth observed in markets such as Australia, France, and Japan. In contrast, Brazil and Argentina have both experienced declines in QSR digital ad spend in recent years.

Source: Sensor Tower
Note: Includes a selection of advertising channels. Ad spend estimates as of April 7, 2026. Available ad channels vary by market. See [Appendix \(page 30\)](#) for a list of ad channels included in each market.

Fast Food & Fast Casual Digital Ad Spend by Country



Fast Food & Fast Casual Digital Ad Impressions by Country



Included Ad Channels

Only select ad channels are available in each market

Ad Channel	Included?
Social Networks	
Facebook	✓
Instagram	✓
LINE	○
LinkedIn	✓
NAVER	○
Pinterest	✓
Reddit	✓
Snapchat	✓
TikTok	✓
X	✓
YouTube	✓
Display & Video	
Desktop Display	✓
Desktop Video	✓
Linear TV	✓
Mobile Apps	✓
Mobile Display	✓
Mobile Video	○
OTT	✓

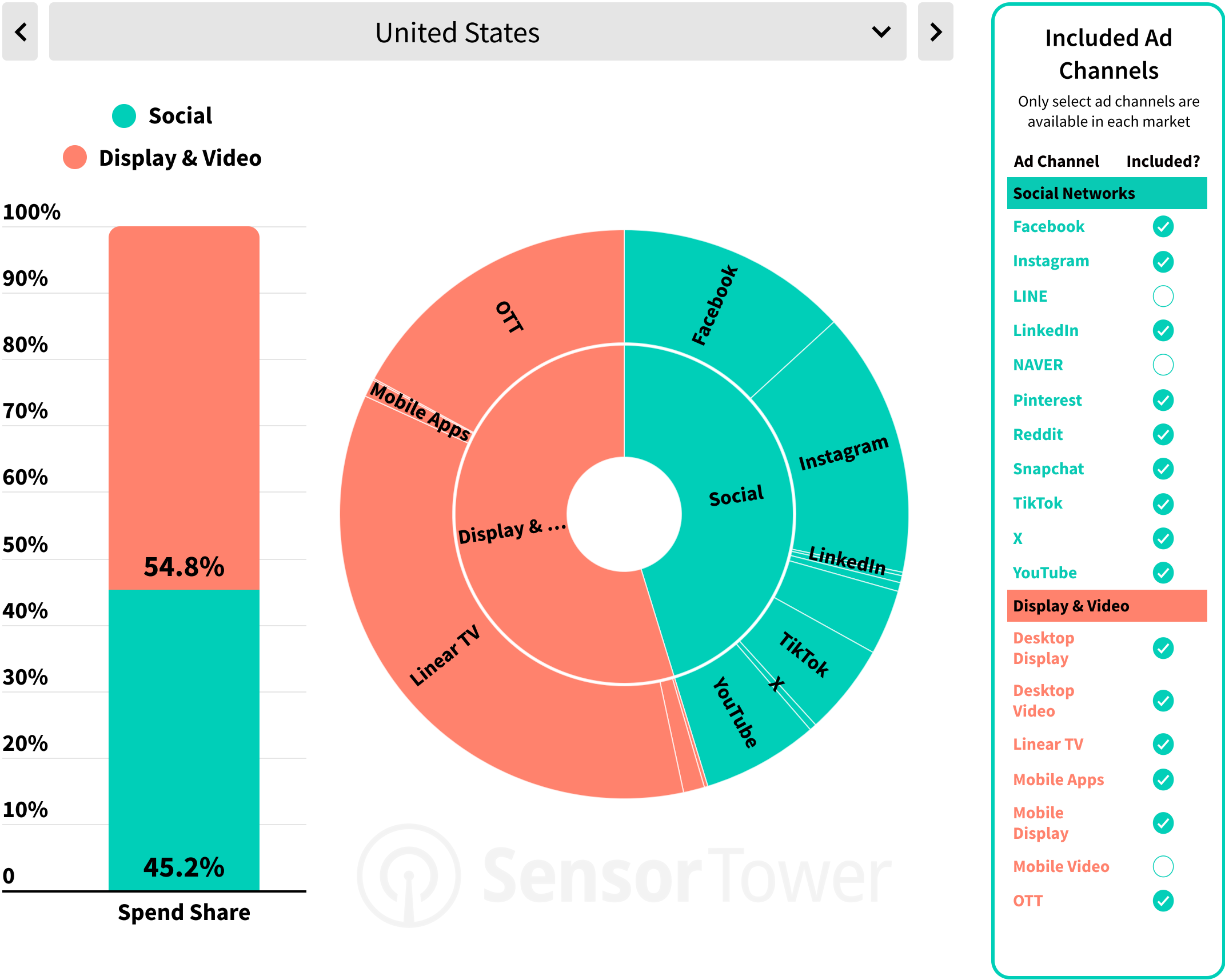
QSR Brands Embrace Linear TV and OTT for Digital Advertising

In the United States, Linear TV and OTT accounted for 52% of fast food and fast casual ad spend between Q2 2025 and Q1 2026, significantly higher than the broader market, where these channels represented roughly 34% of total digital ad spend over the same period.

On social channels, Instagram captured the largest share of QSR ad spend, followed by Facebook and YouTube. TikTok and Snapchat also represented a comparatively higher share of QSR ad spend relative to their share of overall digital advertising.

Source: Sensor Tower
Note: Includes a selection of advertising channels. Ad spend estimates as of April 7, 2026. Available ad channels vary by market. See [Appendix \(page 30\)](#) for a list of ad channels included in each market.

Share of Fast Food & Fast Casual Digital Ad Spend by Channel, Q2 2025 - Q1 2026



Sensor Tower

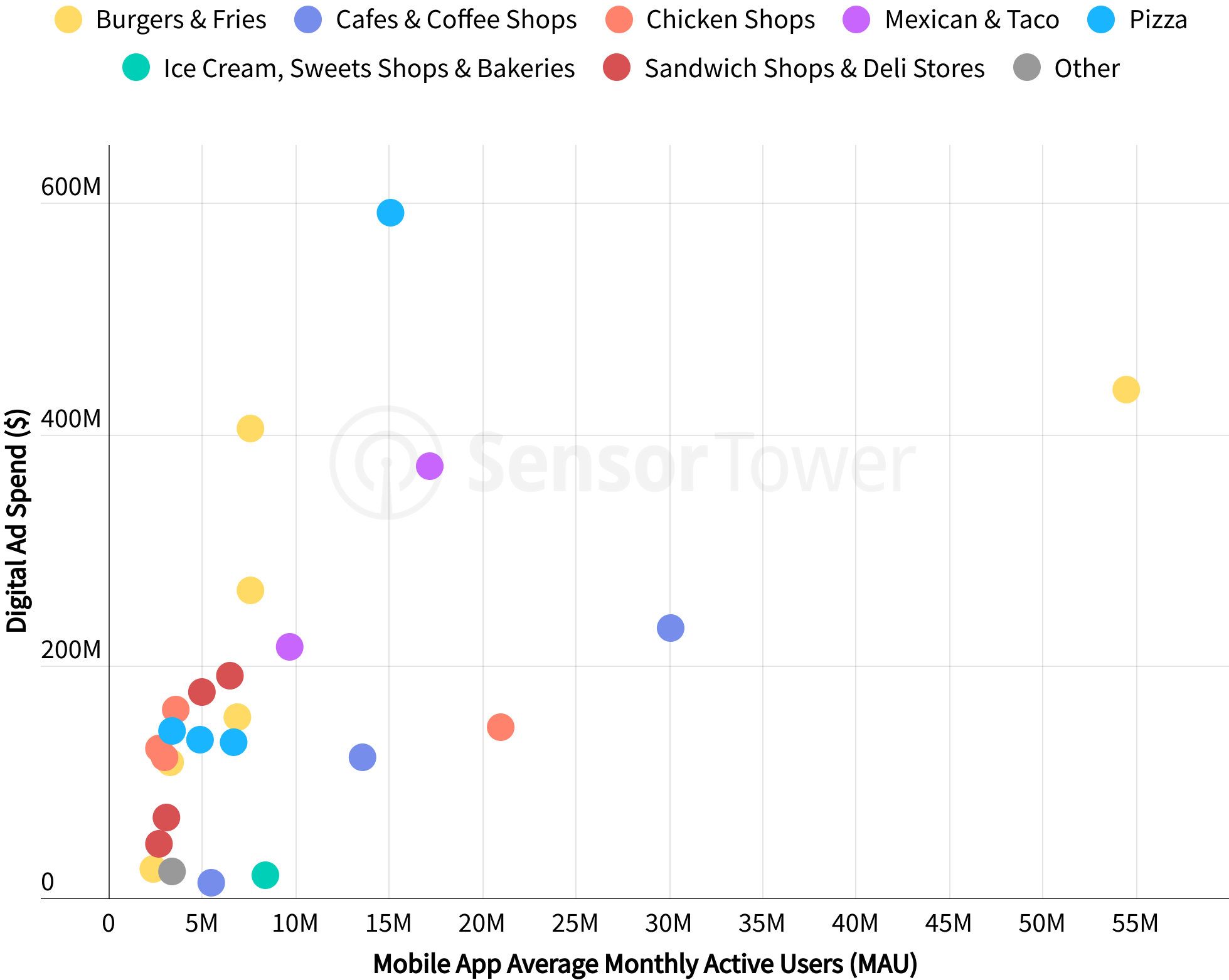
Mobile Becomes Central to QSR Strategies for Customer Loyalty

Leading QSR brands are increasingly leveraging mobile apps to enhance the customer experience and drive loyalty. Apps provide seamless access to rewards programs and enable convenient pickup and delivery options, making “fast food” even faster.

In the United States, six QSR brands recorded at least 10 million average monthly active users (MAUs) in 2025, while 29 apps surpassed 1 million MAUs. Brands such as McDonald’s, Starbucks, Chick-fil-A, Dunkin’, and Crumbl stand out for their strong mobile user bases relative to their investment in digital advertising.

Source: Sensor Tower
Note: Mobile app users across iOS and Google Play. Includes a selection of advertising channels. Ad spend estimates as of April 7, 2026. See [Appendix \(page 30\)](#) for a list of ad channels included in each market.

Digital Ad Spend vs. Mobile App Monthly Users (MAU)
United States, 2025



Subway Revives Its Popular Sub Club Program... Temporarily

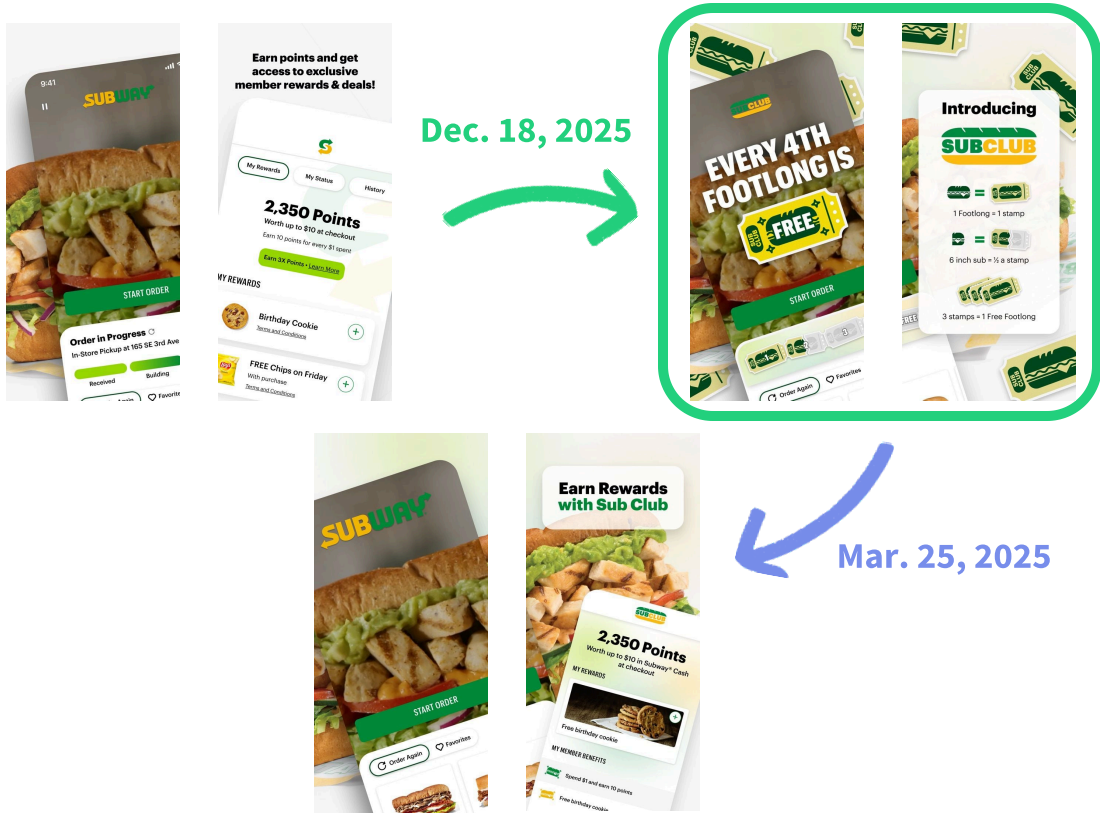
On December 1, 2025, Subway announced the return of its Sub Club rewards program for the first time in 20 years, featuring a compelling offer: a free footlong after every three purchased. Following the launch, Subway's mobile app downloads in the US surged 19% compared to the prior four months, reversing a downward trend observed in recent years.

Subway ended the free sub promotion on April 1, 2026, with updates reflected across its App Store screenshots and digital advertising. It remains to be seen whether the brand can sustain the momentum generated by its short-lived rewards program.

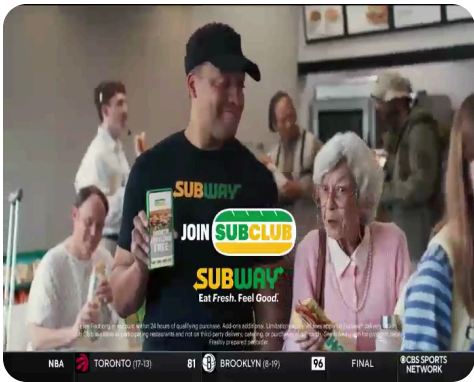
Source: Sensor Tower
Note: App downloads across iOS and Google Play.

Subway "Sub Club" Marketing Campaigns

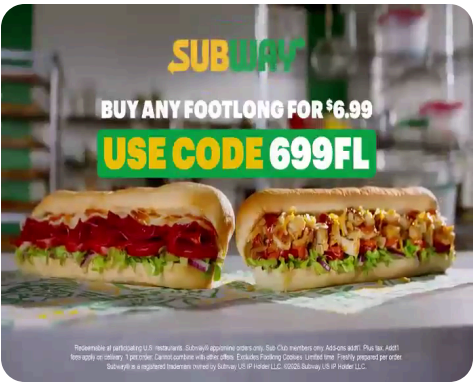
iOS App Store Screenshots



Digital Advertising Creatives



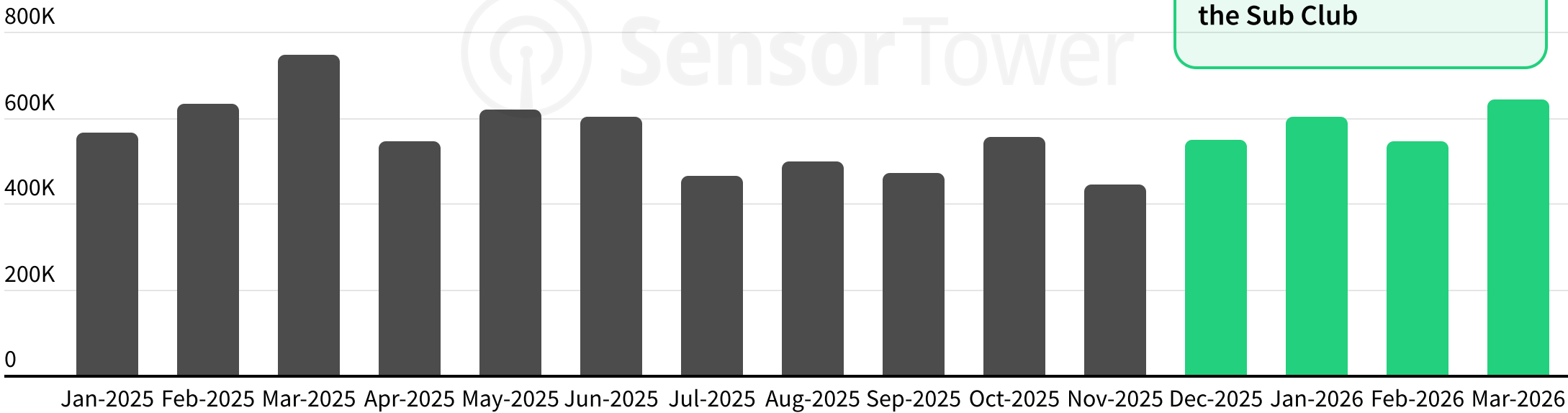
Ad creative on Linear TV
Dates Seen: December, 12 2025 - February 14, 2026
Top Publishers:
• ESPN Network
• CBS Network
• NBC Network
• FOX Network



Ad creative on Linear TV
Dates Seen: February, 4 - April 6, 2026
Top Publishers:
• MTV Network
• Lifetime Network
• NBC Network

Subway Monthly Mobile App Downloads

United States, iOS and Google Play



+19% vs. the prior four months since adding the Sub Club

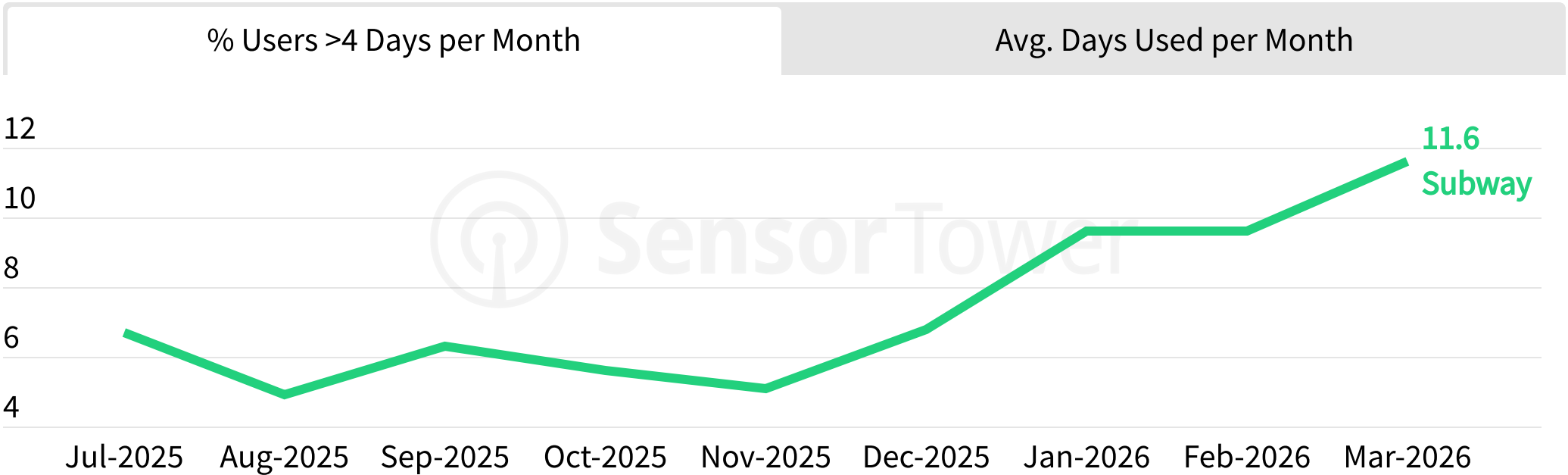
Subway's Sub Club Offer Drove Immediate Gains in Engagement and Loyalty

Subway's Sub Club promotion delivered a meaningful lift in mobile engagement. The share of users opening the app more than four days per month more than doubled between November 2025 and March 2026, while average monthly usage per user increased from 1.8 to 2.3 days.

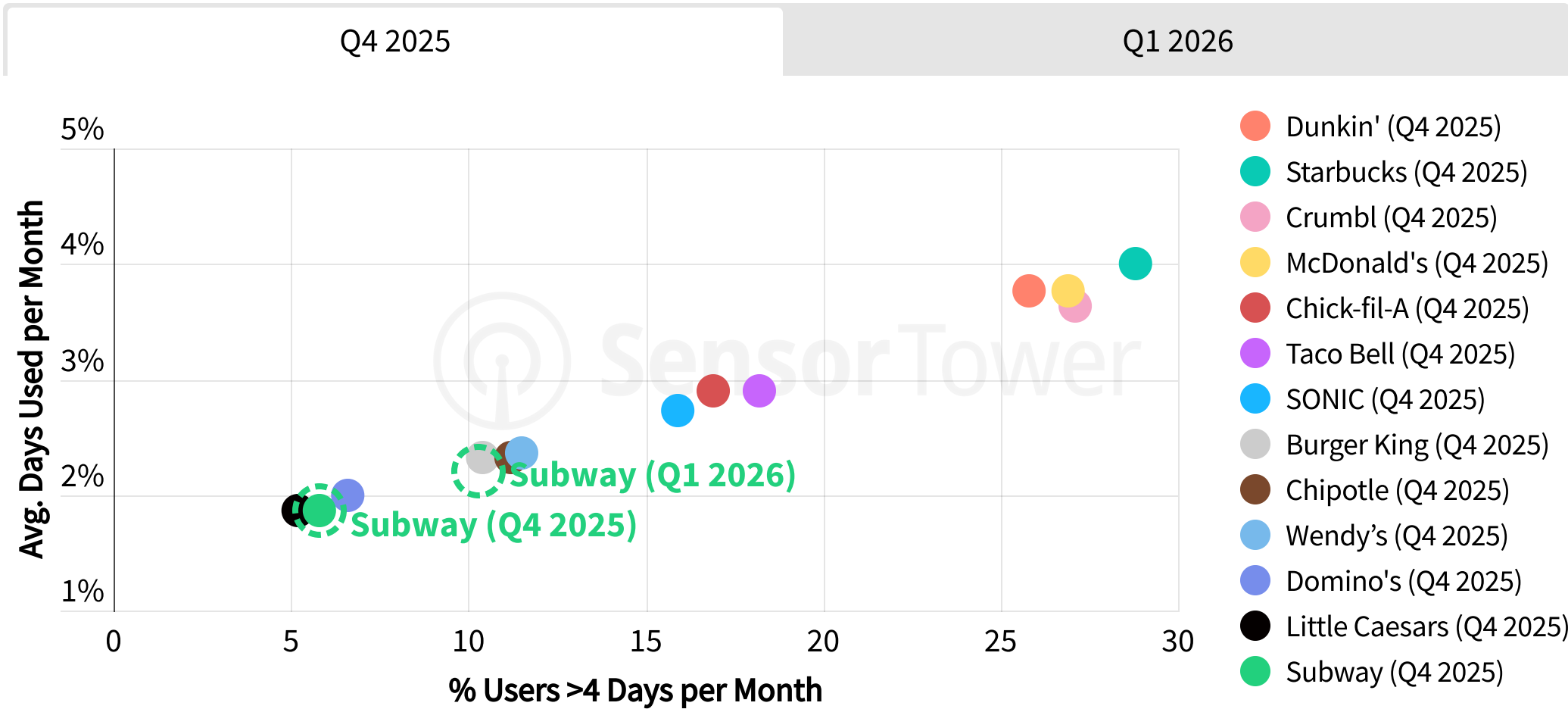
Prior to the promotion, Subway's engagement levels were comparable to leading pizza brands such as Domino's and Little Caesars. By Q1 2026, it had moved closer to the next tier of QSR apps, including Wendy's and Chipotle, though engagement still trailed the category's top performers.

Source: Sensor Tower
Note: Android phones in the United States.

Subway User Engagement in the United States



Engagement for Top Fast Food & Fast Casual Apps in the United States



Crumbl Builds a Strong Mobile User Base Among Young Women

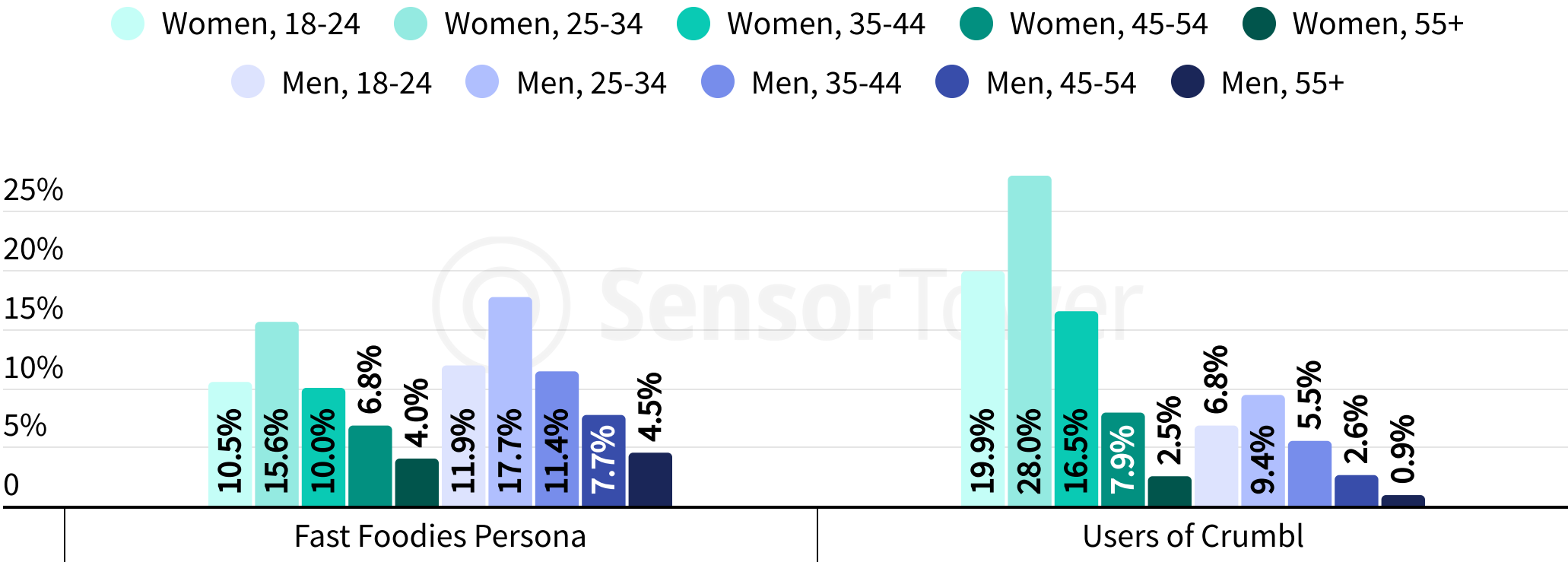
As noted on [page 20](#), Crumbl overperforms in building a strong mobile presence, in part by appealing to a highly mobile-centric audience: young women. Crumbl ranked #8 by US MAU in Q1 2026, ahead of Burger King, Little Caesars, and Wendy's.

In the United States, nearly half of Crumbl’s app users are women under 35—almost double the share among fast food consumers overall. See [page 11](#) for a comparison of Crumbl’s mobile demographic profile versus other leading QSR apps.

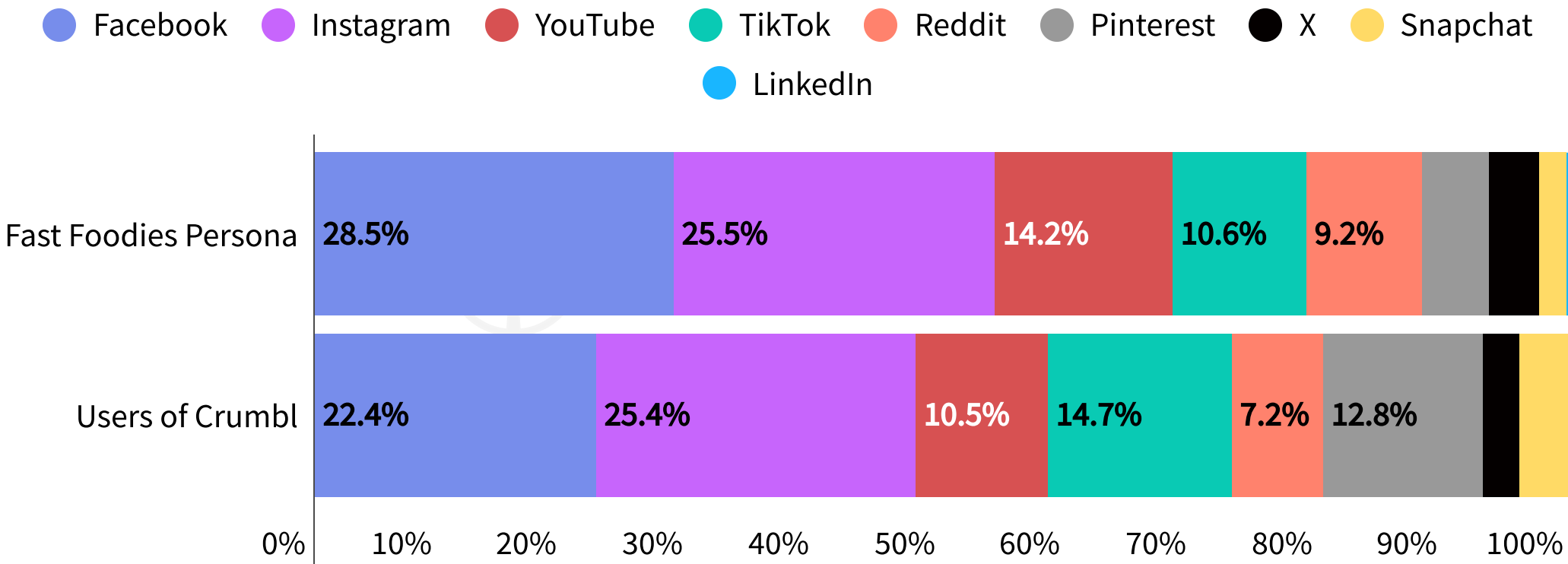
This audience skews exposure toward social platforms that are especially popular with younger women, including Pinterest, Snapchat, and TikTok. For example, nearly 13% of Crumbl users’ social ad impressions occurred on Pinterest, compared to roughly 5% for fast food consumers overall.

Source: Sensor Tower Audience Insights

Demographics in the United States for Fast Foodies vs. Crumbl Users, Q1 2026



Top Social Ad Channels by Share of Ad Impressions for Each Audience
Q1 2026 in the United States

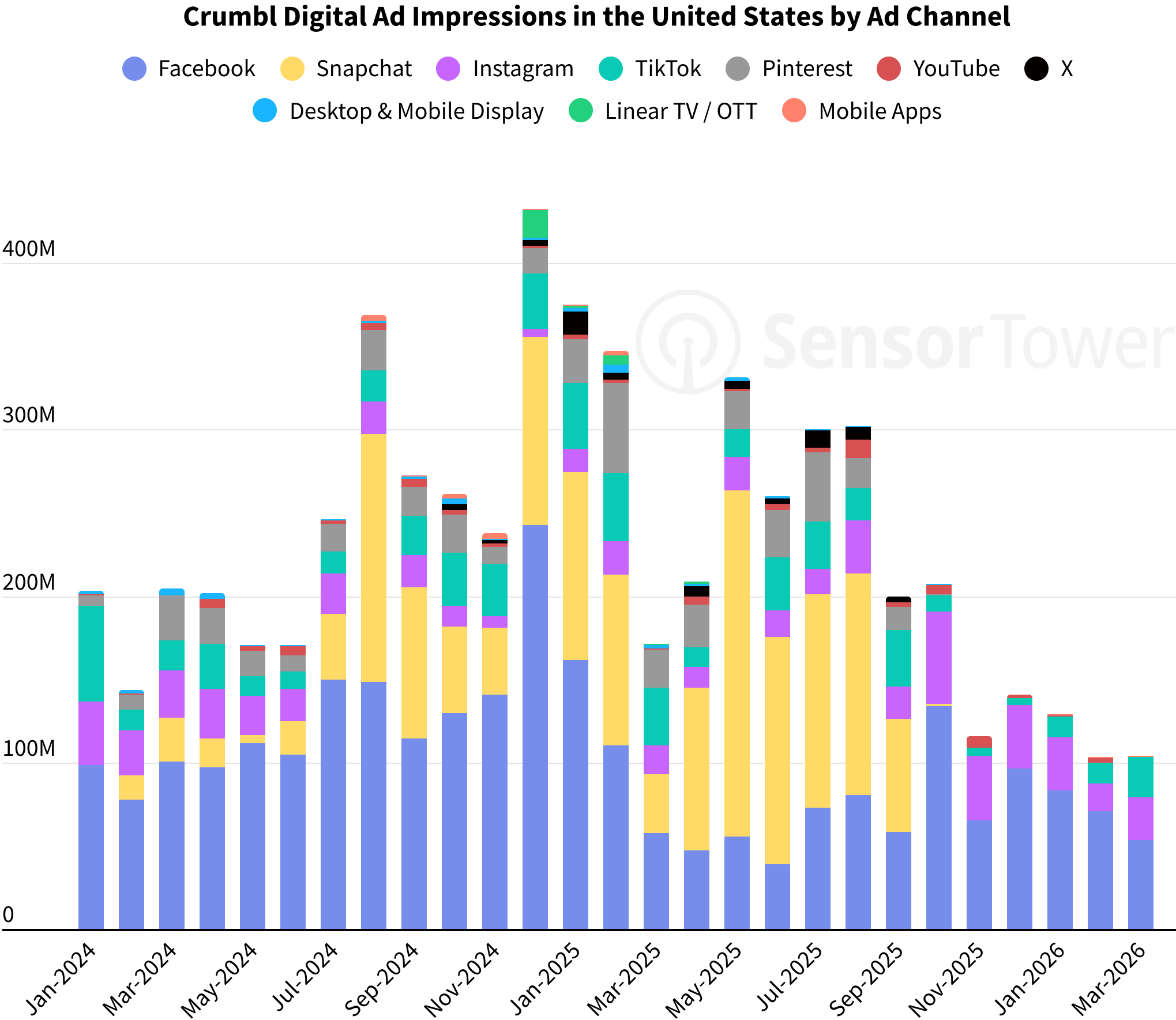


Crumbl's Unique Audience Shapes Its Social Media Advertising Strategy

Crumbl aligned its digital ad mix to reach its disproportionately young, female audience, investing heavily in Snapchat and Pinterest creatives throughout 2025.

In recent months, however, Crumbl appears to have pulled back on digital ad spend, potentially signaling a shift from user acquisition toward deeper engagement and loyalty. Despite this, the app still surpassed one million downloads in Q1 2026, though this marked its lowest quarterly total in nearly five years (since Q2 2021).

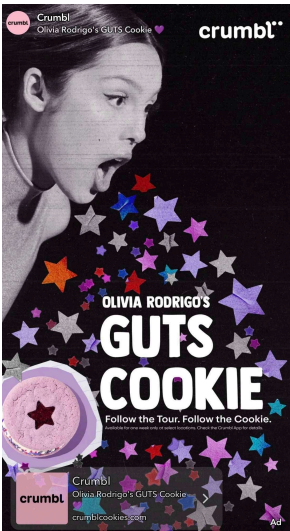
Source: Sensor Tower
Note: Includes a selection of advertising channels. Ad spend estimates as of April 7, 2026. See [Appendix \(page 30\)](#) for a list of ad channels included in each market.



How Crumbl Reached a Young Audience and Drove Mobile Adoption

Crumbl’s creative strategy highlights how the brand successfully drove strong adoption among young female users. Several key patterns stand out, including partnerships with celebrities such as Olivia Rodrigo and Benson Boone, targeted holiday campaigns, and a consistent emphasis on rewards available through its mobile app.

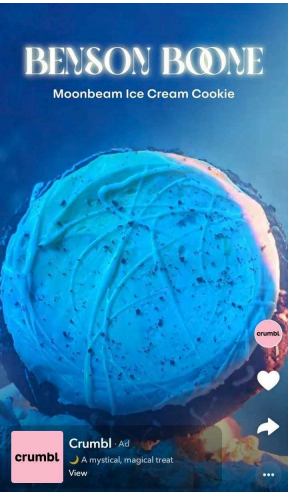
Celebrities & Trends



Ad creative on Snapchat (February - August 2024)

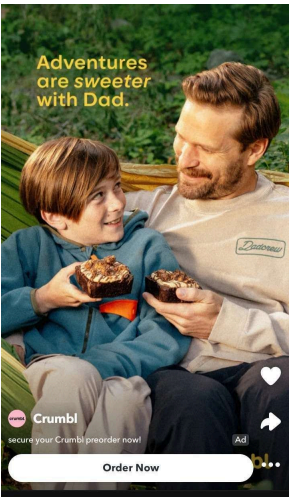


Ad creative on Snapchat (August 2025)



Ad creative on Snapchat (June - July 2025)

Holidays



Ad creative on Snapchat (May - June 2025)

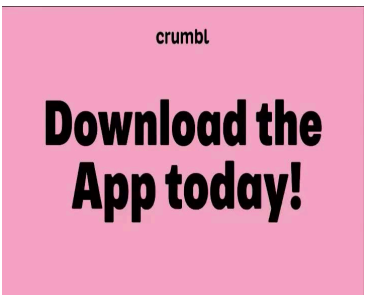


Ad creative on Snapchat (April - May 2025)



Ad creative on Linear TV (January - March, 2025)

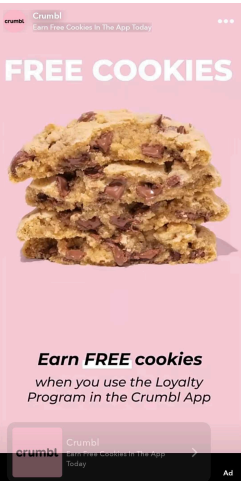
Mobile App & Rewards



Ad creative on Linear TV (December 2024 - February 2025)



Ad creative on Instagram (November 2025 - April 2026)



Ad creative on Snapchat (March 2024 - September 2025)

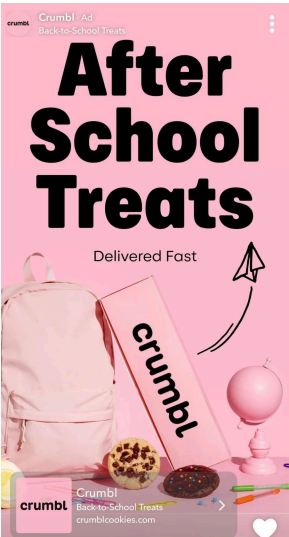


Ad creative on Facebook (June - November 2025)

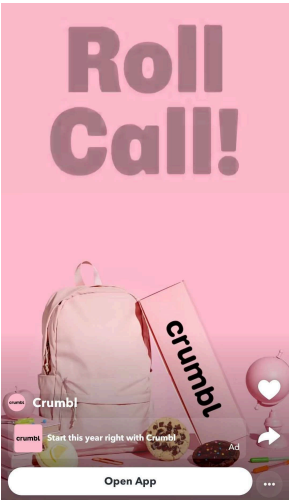


Ad creative on YouTube (September 2025 - February 2026)

Students



Ad creative on Snapchat (August - September 2025)



Ad creative on Snapchat (August - September 2024)

Retail Media Advertising

Top QSR Apps Leverage Food Delivery Partnerships

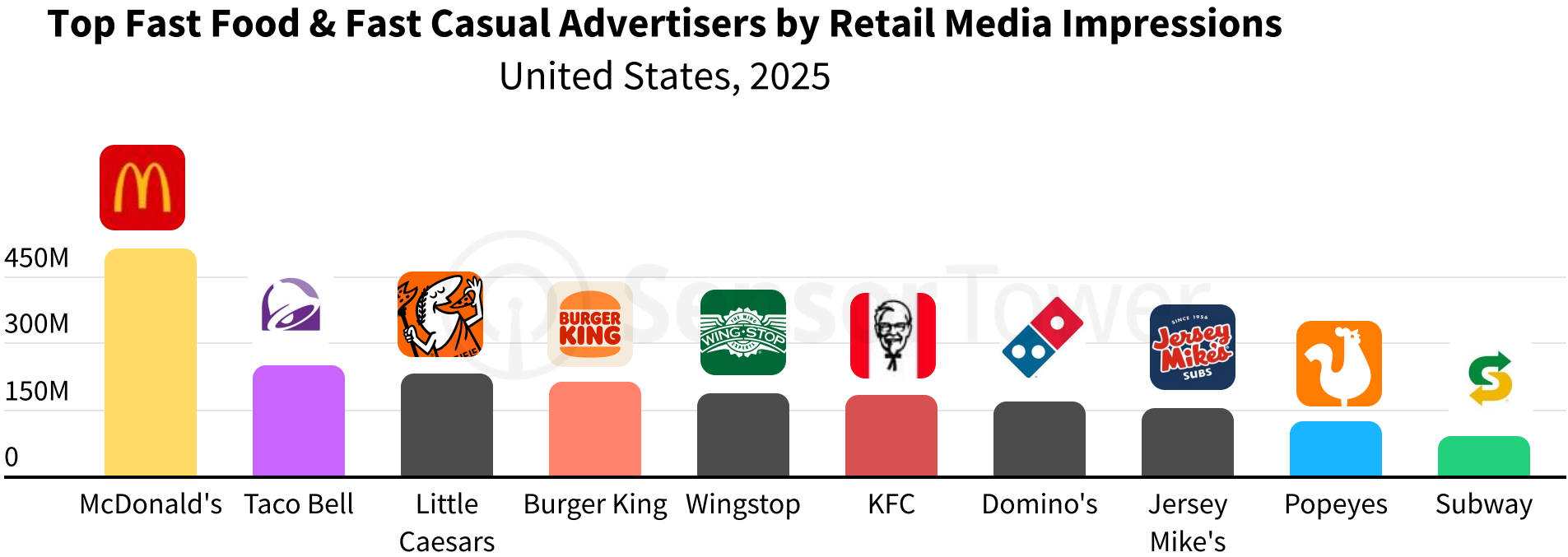
Leading QSR brands increasingly partner with food delivery platforms to promote their offerings and acquire new customers through targeted promotions and deals. Several major restaurants maintain partnerships across multiple delivery services, including McDonald’s (the top advertiser by impressions on both Uber Eats and Grubhub), Taco Bell, KFC, and Wendy’s.

Given the nature of these partnerships, it is unsurprising that fast food app users are more likely than the average mobile user to fall into the “Delivery Diners” persona (i.e., users of food delivery apps). For example, KFC users are 3.9x more likely to be Delivery Diners than the average mobile user. See page 11 for a more detailed breakdown of top personas among QSR app users in the United States.

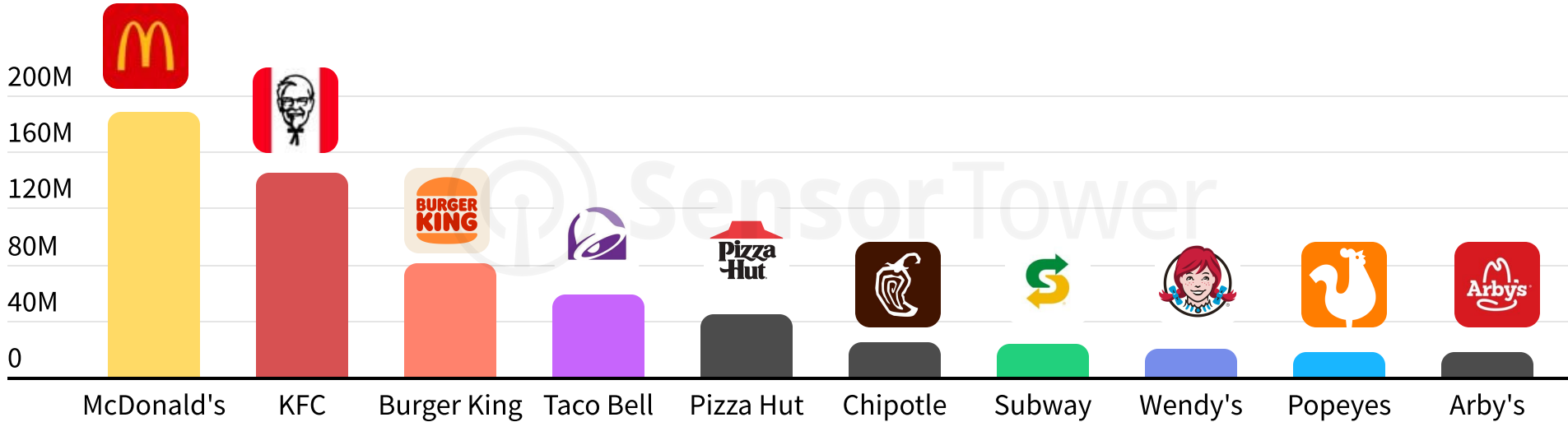
Source: Sensor Tower



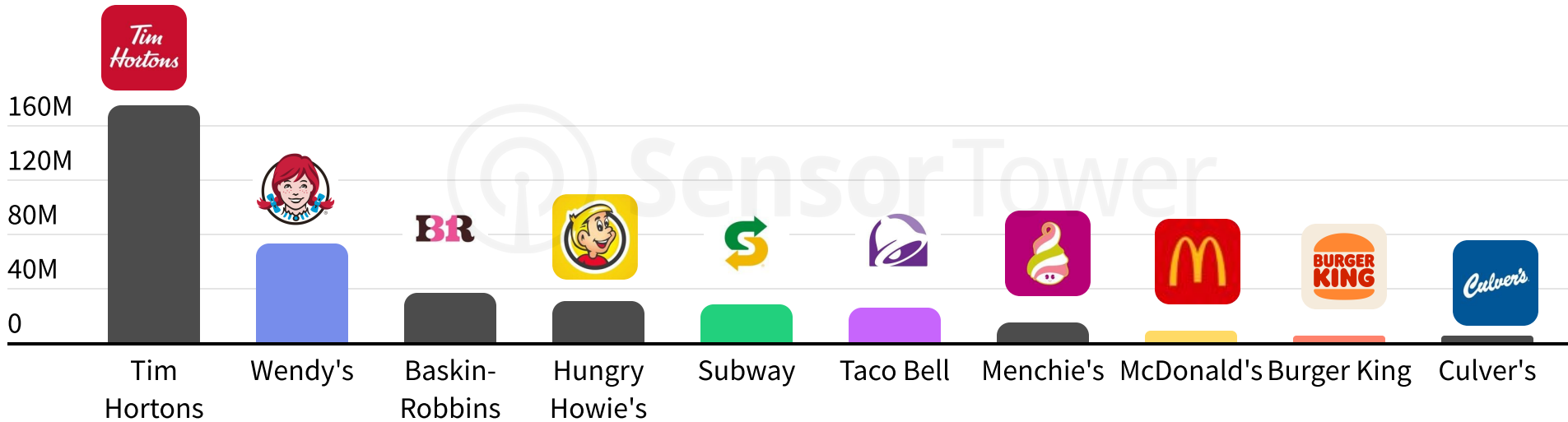
Uber Ads



Grubhub Media Network



DoorDash Advertising



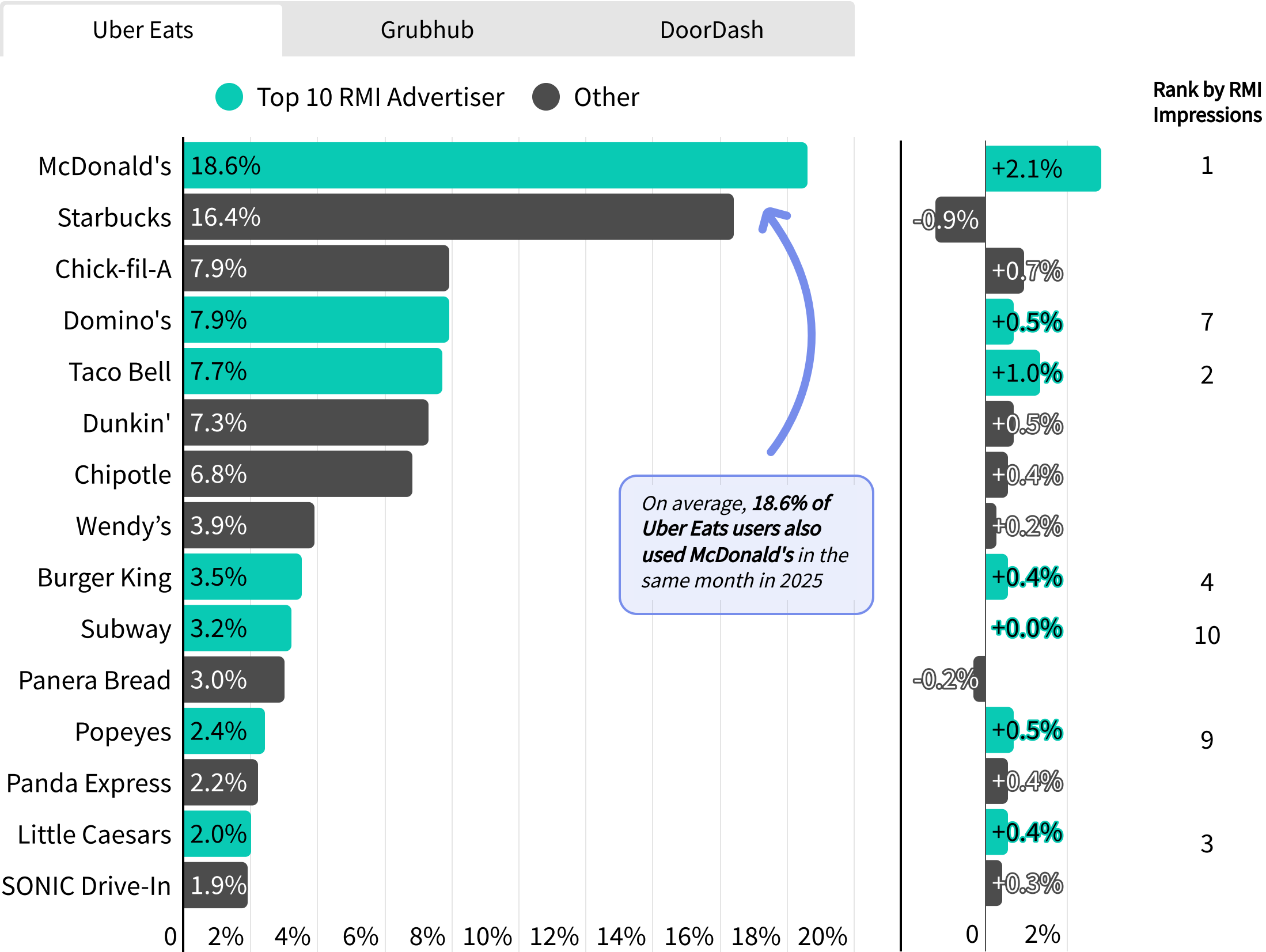
Retail Media Can Help Boost QSR's Own App Usage Too

While retail media campaigns are primarily designed to drive orders through food delivery platforms, these partnerships can also increase usage of QSR's own apps. Customers who order via delivery apps may subsequently download a restaurant's own app to access rewards or take advantage of in-store and pickup options.

In many cases, leading retail media advertisers have seen increased engagement with their own apps among food delivery users. For example, in 2025 an average of 18.6% of Uber Eats users also used the McDonald's app in the same month, up 2.1% year over year, highlighting how McDonald's is gaining traction among delivery app audiences.

Source: Sensor Tower

Top Fast Food & Fast Casual Advertisers by Retail Media Impressions
United States, 2025



Many QSR Brands Offer Strong Incentives to New Users

Uber Eats retail media creatives frequently emphasize steep discounts for new users, while Grubhub ads more often highlight offers such as a free item. DoorDash includes promotions less consistently, though it occasionally features free delivery or limited-time deals. Find out how your competitors are incentivizing new users to stay competitive!

Uber Eats

Uber Ads

Jersey Mike's
FREE Turkey & Provolone sub
with orders \$15+ on Uber Eats

Uber Eats
TikTok
@user151886555

Tim Hortons | Uber Eats

\$15 off your first order when you spend \$30+ Use code: CA36J2U. New users only. Terms apply.

Order Tim Hortons on Uber Eats

Delivery in as little as 25 minutes

Tim Hortons

\$15 off your first order Use App

uber eats Sponsored

\$15 off your first order of \$20 or more. Use code: US36J5H. New users only. Terms Apply.

McDonald's ad creative on Instagram

GH

Grubhub Media Network

grubhub Sponsored

Freebie Fridays

FREE item with a \$20+ order

Terms & fees apply.

FREE Famous Bowl

KFC

Order Now

grubhub Snag a tasty treat from your favorite spots for FREE every Friday. 🍔 🍗 🍕 Terms & fees apply.

Grubhub Sponsored

Get \$15 off \$50 at Taco Bell on Grubhub

Taco Bell

Order Now

Order now

Grubhub Sponsored

Free food is our love language. Soak it in. Spend \$20+ to save, this weekend only. Terms & fees apply.

GRUBHUB McDonald's

FREE McCrispy® or 10pc McNuggets®

With \$20+. Terms & fees apply. See app for details.

Freebie wknd

McDonald's on Grubhub

Order now

McDonald's ad creative on Facebook

DoorDash Advertising

DoorDash Sponsored

Order now and get extra savings at Pizza Hut® with 50% off 1 large pizza. Today only. 2/9. Terms apply.

DoorDash Pizza Hut

50% OFF 1 LARGE PIZZA FROM PIZZA HUT®

60% OFF

NATIONAL PIZZA DAY 2/9/2026 NATIONAL PIZZA DAY

Order now

Pizza Hut ad creative on Facebook

DoorDash Sponsored

Protect your Taco Bell. Free Crunchwrap Supreme®, Chicken Quesadilla, or Beefy 5-Layer Burrito w/\$22+. 1/27-1/31. *Terms apply. Excluding taxes, fee... see more

Taco Bell

Unlock a free favorite. Order Now

Taco Bell ad creative on Facebook

doordash Sponsored

Find your favorite dish or try something new on DoorDash.

Tim Hortons

ad creative on Instagram

Appendix:

Digital Advertising Ad Channels by Market

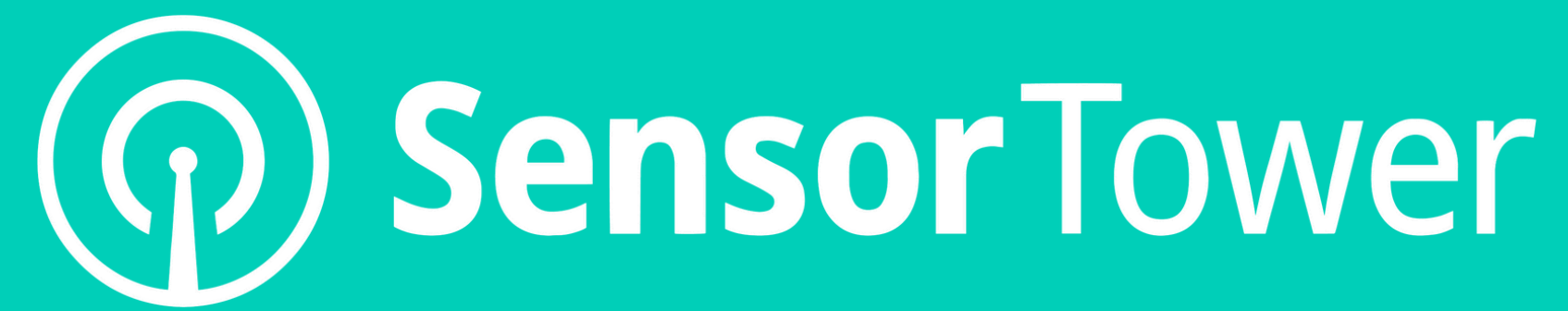
Data includes select channels in each market. Figures in this report represent the totals for these channels only, not across all digital formats.

- At this time, our technology allows us to report down to nine individual streaming services: Amazon Prime Video, Disney+, HBO Max, Hulu, Netflix, Peacock, Paramount+, tubi and PlutoTV. All other OTT campaigns outside of these nine services are grouped into a single OTT Streaming Services (General) bucket.
- These are available for Sensor Tower customers at <https://pathmatics.sensortower.com> or you can [request a demo here](#).

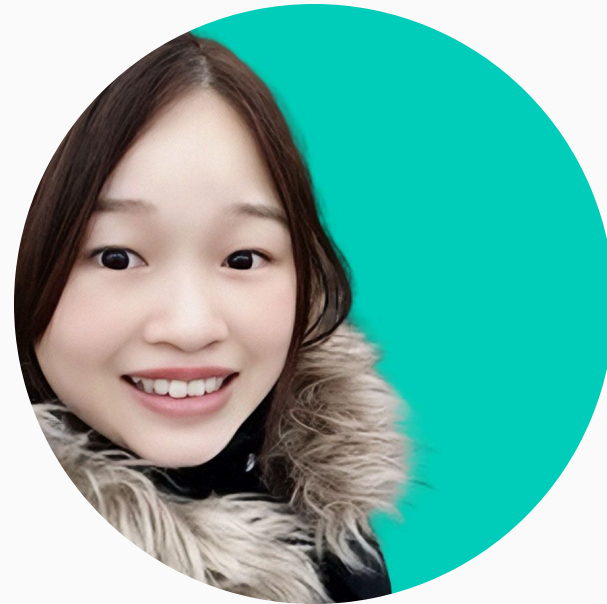
Included Ad Channels by Market

Key:  Included ad channel  Recently added channel (only included in select slides)  Ad channel not included in market

	AMER	EMEA				APAC
Ad Channel	Argentina	Brazil	Canada	Colombia	Mexico	United States
Social Networks						
Facebook						
Instagram						
LINE						
LinkedIn						
NAVER						
Pinterest						
Reddit						
Snapchat						
TikTok						
X						
YouTube						
Display & Video						
Desktop Display						
Desktop Video						
Linear TV						
Mobile Apps						
Mobile Display						
Mobile Video						
OTT						



Meet the authors



Yuwen Huang
Senior Market Insights Analyst



Yuwen has been analyzing the digital economy since 2021, specializing in digital advertising and non-game verticals including Retail, Streaming, and Food & Drink. She is the lead analyst for Sensor Tower's reports including the State of Food Delivery & Rideshare and the quarterly Digital Market Index.

Favorite App in 2025: rednote



Jonathan Briskman
Director, Market Insights



Jonathan leads Sensor Tower's Market Insights team, covering trends across the digital economy, from mobile and web to digital advertising. Since 2018, he has helped shape Sensor Tower's market research, including reports such as the State of AI Apps and the State of Digital Advertising.

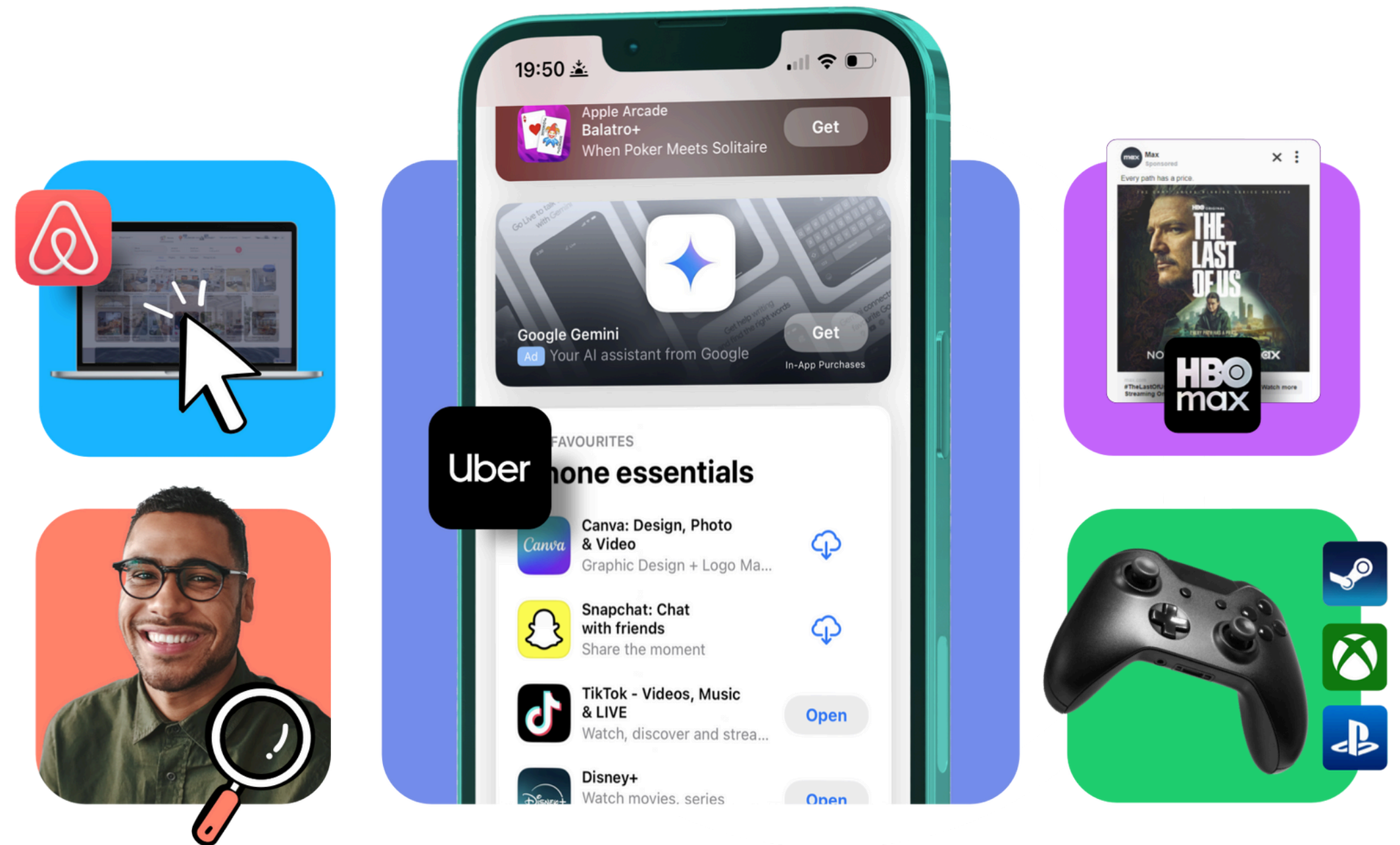
Favorite App in 2025: Strava

About Sensor Tower

Sensor Tower is a global provider of digital intelligence solutions, empowering companies to understand consumer behavior and market performance across mobile apps, digital platforms, and gaming ecosystems. Headquartered in San Francisco, Sensor Tower's insights are trusted by more than 2,500 enterprises worldwide.

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